

1320.4 Aeronautics:UFO

Headquarters Action Tracking System (HATS)
INCOMING CORRESPONDENCE ACTION
ID Number: L/1998-00407

Title: WARD/Sen Snowe fwds ltr from (b) (6) who's interested in U.F.O. and the recent Mars photo

Recipient: L/Heffernan

Author: SNOWE
Organization: SENATE

Date Written: 05/18/1998
Date Received: 05/26/1998
Date Concurred:
Date Submitted:
Date Signed: 06/24/1998
Date Closed: 06/24/1998
>>Current Due Date: 06/18/1998<<
Original Due Date:

Action Office: L/Ward:S

Status: Closed

Signature Office: L/Heffernan

Info Offices: L/Heffernan, L/Heninger, L/Kerwin

Abstract:
SEN SNOWE FWDS LTR FROM (b) (6) OF STOCKINGTON, MAINE, WHO'S INTERESTED IN U.F.O.'S AND THE RECENT PHOTOS OF MARS WHICH WERE RECENTLY RELEASED.

Comments:

Enclosures: NO

Related Records:

Keywords: (b) (6) MAINE U.F.O. MARS

File Plan: 1320.4

Analyst: BMoore

06/24/1998

Page 1 of 1

1320.4 Heffernan: UFO's

Headquarters Action Tracking System (HATS)
INCOMING CORRESPONDENCE ACTION
ID Number: L/1998-00729

Title: Rothman/UFO Sightings by Astronauts

Recipient: L/Heffernan

Author: Grassley

Organization: Senate

Date Written: 08/03/1998

Date Received: 08/31/1998

Date Concurred:

Date Submitted:

Date Signed: 09/04/1998

Date Closed: 09/10/1998

Action Office: LD/Rothman:P

>>**Current Due Date:** 08/22/1998<<

Original Due Date: 08/22/1998

Status: Closed

Signature Office: L/Heffernan

Info Offices: L/Heffernan, L/Heninger, L/Kerwin

Abstract:

Senator Grassley forwards letter from (b) (6) who is requesting information on UFO sightings by Astronauts.

Comments:

Enclosures: letter

Related Records:

Keywords: (b) (6) UFO, astronauts, sightings
File Plan: 1320.4

Analyst: JMassey

09/10/1998

Page 1 of 1

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SEP - 4 1998

L:HR:mtg:L/1998-729f

The Honorable Charles E. Grassley
United States Senate
Washington, DC 20510

Dear Senator Grassley:

Thank you for your letter of August 3, 1998, on behalf of (b) (6) who is requesting information about the possible sightings of Unidentified Flying Objects (UFOs) by NASA astronauts.

Over the years there have been many objects sighted by the astronauts during space missions. Most of these items were later identified by photographs or NORAD records as material from launch vehicles or spacecraft or were such items as water droplets. No unidentified materials were seen on missions to the moon. The Air Force, in the interest of national security, received and investigated all reports for many years but has discontinued this activity. NASA has no program for investigating UFOs and has not withheld information on sightings.

In 1976, James Oberg thoroughly researched the UFO/astronaut allegations and published an article about it in SEARCH magazine. We are enclosing that article for (b) (6) information. In addition, enclosed is a NASA Fact Sheet which summarizes the current status of NASA's involvement in UFO investigations.

We trust this information will aid you in responding to (b) (6) inquiry.

Sincerely,

ORIGINAL SIGNED BY.

Edward Heffernan
Associate Administrator
for Legislative Affairs

Enclosures

+

bcc:

Z/Roger Launius (with incoming) ; provided info

Sent to Sherry Kuntz in the Hill office

VR

9/2/98

My - 9/3/98

Since the "astronaut UFO" genre is one of the main pillars of UFO evidence, this study claiming that the entire set of cases is invalid will obviously be received with skepticism and criticism from UFO buffs. Rational objections and arguments will be printed and answered in a subsequent issue of this magazine. Critics are urged to raise specific points not addressed in the study, or to cite and document facts which might modify or invalidate conclusions in the study.

-- The Whole Story!

James E. Oberg

Associate Editor

"Space World" magazine

SEARCH Magazine
WINTER 1976 (Issue #129)
PALMER PUBLICATIONS
AMHERST, WISC. 54406
Single copy price \$1.25

Space flight has opened many mysteries. True, scientists prefer to list the puzzles solved and unknowns discovered, but as men venture beyond the earth it is inevitable that new mysteries will be encountered.

Somewhere out there, many observers believe, are intelligent species with technological civilizations far more advanced than that of Earth. Perhaps they are sending us radio signals we have not recognized. Perhaps they have left artifacts of past visits for us to find. Perhaps they are even now keeping the earth under surveillance.

If they are out there, someday we will meet them. As illustrated in science fiction, this meeting will probably occur in space.

Have such meetings already occurred? Have astronauts and cosmonauts already seen alien spacecraft? The UFO literature is full of tales of "space UFOs". Are any of them valid? What can a careful study reveal?

Hardly a UFO book or movie is complete without the standard assertion that "astronauts have seen UFOs too". While critics may attack the character or intelligence of many UFO witnesses, they cannot use these tactics on American and Russian space pilots. Where UFO photographs can be accused of distortion and forgery, photographs taken by astronauts and processed by NASA must be of the highest trustworthiness. Hence, most UFO scholars consider the family of astronaut UFO sightings to be one of the strongest bodies of evidence in the past thirty years.

The best of these cases include astronaut James McDivitt's sighting of an "unidentified spacecraft" near his Gemini-4 space capsule in 1965, a curious photo of a pair of UFOs with glowing propulsion fields taken by the Gemini-7 astronauts, reports of nearby objects from X-15 and Mercury spacecraft, tales of how the 1968-1969 Apollo moon shots were followed by UFOs on their way to the moon, and reports and photographs of objects seen by crewmen on the Skylab space station. Last year, the National Inves-

tigations Committee on Aerial Phenomena (NICAP) selected the "McDivitt UFO" photo as one of the four best photographs ever taken.

The "astronaut UFO" sightings must appeal to many serious researchers for a number of reasons. The witnesses and the photographs are unimpeachable as to honesty and authenticity. The conditions of the space missions can be calculated and recorded, and every object near the spacecraft can be determined by consulting the giant space radars of the North American Air Defense Command (NORAD), headquartered inside Cheyenne Mountain in Colorado. Extensive crew debriefings and on-board tape recorder transcripts may be available to obtain direct eye-witness testimony.

With all these facts and assumptions in mind, and mindful of the numerous 'unsolved' cases which might tell much about the UFO phenomenon, I began a special research program into this particular body of evidence. As an aerospace writer, historian, and researcher, I felt that my experience with astronautics, computers, Air

Force operations, and space missions might give me new insights into this most puzzling series of cases. I was not disappointed, and my results were startling.

The basic truths behind these sightings seems lately to have gathered an accretion of exaggeration, confusion, and outright fiction. The 1968 "Condon Report" on UFOs (conducted by the University of Colorado for the U.S. Air Force) found itself unable to penetrate three specific cases, which the analyst felt were a "challenge" to any serious investigator. Stories later began circulating about sightings of lunar surface lights and structures, and the discovery of artifacts on the moon, about near approaches of structured objects, and about attempts at radio contact between Apollo capsules and UFOs. Recent books on UFOs give lists of astronaut sightings which are out of numeric sequence, misdated, misspelled, and otherwise distorted.

My research has revealed a few examples of deliberate photo forgeries by UFO buffs or opportunistic authors. My investigations in the NASA

archives has revealed cases where UFO researchers withheld certain information freely given them by NASA officials, information which would have clearly explained many cases which the authors wanted to appear mysterious. So the time has come to take a new look at this whole phenomenon. What is the truth about "astronaut UFOs"?

The first step in any research might be with the Condon report, thought by many to have been commissioned as a "whitewash" of the UFO phenomenon. UFO enthusiasts are accustomed to hearing harsh criticism of almost all aspects of this study, but my own objections to the "astronaut UFO" section is from a novel angle.

My own research suggests that the Condon investigator, far from being the best man for the job, was clearly unqualified to evaluate the difficult cases. He was not familiar with the terminology of space flight or the basics of orbital flight trajectories, as I am. As a result, he ignored possible explanations while incorrectly eliminating other possible answers.

In other words, far from being a coverup, this chapter of the Condon report is superficial. It is entirely worthless as an endorsement of the unexplained and unexplainable nature of several astronaut sightings which I will discuss. I can prove this remarkable assertion to any investigator serious enough to consider all the evidence, much of which has never before been published.

The Condon report does give some details about the environment of astronaut sightings, but even here does not go far enough. More stress needs to be put on the visual and photographic limitations of space flight: the windows are far smaller than popularly realized (about half the size of this open magazine at arm's length), and for many years were subject to obscuration and smudging by seepage of sealant and by contamination by rocket fuel. At various points in the flight, the spacecraft was surrounded by clouds of debris (leaking fuel, dumped water, chipping paint, fraying insulation, ejected equipment, and more), while the inside of the weightless cabin was usually plagued with floating particles of dust and debris which often passed in front of cameras pointing out windows. Other satellites should have been visible, since few people realize that on any clear night

Despite the persistent rumors of 'secret space pictures', all photographs taken by NASA in space are in the public domain. That is, any picture taken by an astronaut or an earth resources satellite is available to anyone who wants to pay for it.

There are four tiers of photograph availability, but two are reserved for newsmen only. The structure is as follows:

A. The most popular space photographs taken are lithographed for general free distribution to anyone who asks for them. Several dozen new photographs are added to this list every year. Cost to NASA is a few cents per print.

B. The NASA Public Information Offices at various centers and at headquarters prints glossy photographs of timely news stories for distribution to the news media. Hundreds of these photographs are released every year, but only certified newsmen can receive them for free.

C. Many thousands of other photographs and drawings may be of interest to the news media and are therefore filed at public information offices, but stock copies are not kept. Each request must be filled by actual photo lab orders, which costs NASA about one dollar per photograph.

D. Any citizen who wants copies of any photograph listed in 'B' or 'C' above can get it, but it is entirely reasonable for NASA to expect him to pay for it. News bureau photographs, along with all other flight photography—stills and movies—can be ordered from Bara Studios, P.O. Box 486, Bladensburg, MD 20710. The cost of any photograph ordered by stock number is several dollars apiece. Any cross-referencing or researching will also cost money.

Some ground photographs of astronaut accidents, autopsies, and medical examinations are not releasable for publication. On several Gemini flights, special photographic experiments were undertaken for the DoD, but these involved special cameras and exclusively earth surface targets. In neither case would it be possible to withhold any hypothetical UFO photographs from the public.

Astronaut photographs are indexed by a code which specifies year taken and frame number. S66-12387, for example, would be a NASA photo (not necessarily a space photo) taken in 1966. Beginning with Apollo, space photos were also indexed with a mission code, roll number and frame number (neither of which were repeated on later flights). For example, AS16-108-13005 was taken on the Apollo-16 flight, with the 108th roll of the Apollo project flight film. Movie film is indexed per magazine with similar numbers.

Every photograph ever taken by American astronauts for NASA is on file with Bara Studios and can be obtained by anyone willing to pay for them. Writers who produce 'secret NASA UFO photographs' which they claim are being hidden from the American public are doing a gross disservice to one of the most open and cooperative public information offices of any federal agency.

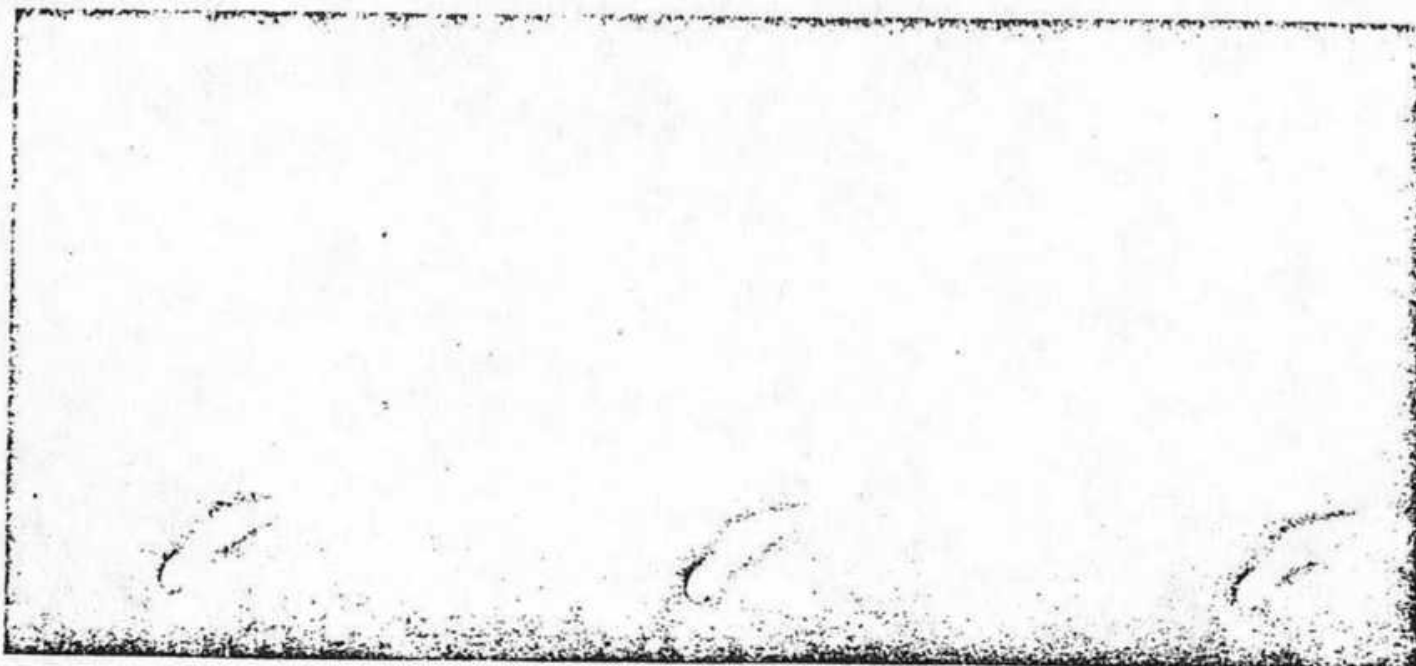
an observer on Earth can see a number of orbiting objects with only half an effort. Out of this "background noise", can we separate the "signal" which will indicate the existence of UFOs?

These problems all are of interest to space officials, and numerous studies have been made. Fragments might imply a structural failure (a rescue ship was almost sent to Skylab-3 because of the crew's observation of leaking fuel droplets). Debris inside the cabin can irritate eyes and damage the electronic gear behind the instrument panels. Other satellites might be dangerous due to the potential of collision or they might be of intelligence interest if they are from some other nation. Therefore, any mysterious space sighting might as easily be vital for

NASA to know about as it might be a true UFO. Careful investigations are called for.

What are some of the most famous cases, and what are the facts? Interpretations may differ, but productive thinking can only be done when all the information is at hand. Some of it is hard to find or understand; other information, available to some researchers, may have been deliberately withheld. Some classical cases may consist of made-up fantasies. You can soon judge for yourself.

Has there been any attempt to "cover up" space sightings (a common plea when no evidence is available, even in this age of sieve-like government secrecy)? Are astronauts "muzzled" about UFOs? Has fifteen



The "McDivitt UFO", prize-winning astronaut photograph taken on Gemini-4. Actually, McDivitt explained later after the flight that the sun was coming across the window as the spacecraft rolled, the sun rays struck a metal bolt, causing the flares in the camera lens.¹
NASA photo 65-H-1013.

years of manned spaceflight uncovered any evidence at all which even remotely suggests that Earth is being visited and observed by advanced spaceships from another world? Let's look at the evidence.

On June 3, 1965, rookie astronauts Jim McDivitt and Ed White blasted off from Cape Kennedy (now again Cape Canaveral), squeezed into their Gemini-4 capsule. The two youngest-ever American spacemen were to spend four days in orbit, tripling the previous US record. They would be the first American space crewmen to have time to sightsee in space, once major experiments like a booster rendezvous and a walk in space were completed.

Approximately thirty hours into the flight (while White was asleep), McDivitt reported that he had seen an object in space near his space capsule. It appeared to be cylindrical with "an arm sticking out", possibly on a collision course. Interested NASA officials in Houston asked NORAD which other space satellites were near Gemini-4 at the time of the sighting, and NORAD came up with a list of about a dozen objects. All of them were pieces of tiny debris or small scientific satellites except one: the giant, "winged" meteor satellite, Pegasus-2. It seemed to fit the description radioed down by McDivitt, so

NASA announced that the object had been identified.

But Pegasus had been more than a thousand miles away, and McDivitt clearly saw an object much closer, much more detailed, and in an orbit very close to his own ("Collision course" to a pilot means that the relative angle of sight is unchanging, which would not be the case for any satellite crossing McDivitt's orbit). The object became a UFO when nobody could identify it. It has remained a UFO up until today, but not any longer.

McDivitt's hasty attempt to take a photograph of the object through his smeared window was apparently fruitless, since the object's motion combined with the slow stabilization spin of the spaceship carried it into the glare of the sun after about 30 seconds. The astronaut later recounted how he went through all the films of the flight (every roll of film is accounted for on a flight manifest, so they do not disappear) and found many overexposed or blank. This mission had been the first flight in which space photography was a major experiment, and the glaring sunlight of space had invalidated many pre-flight exposure settings. McDivitt did not find anything which looked like "his UFO".

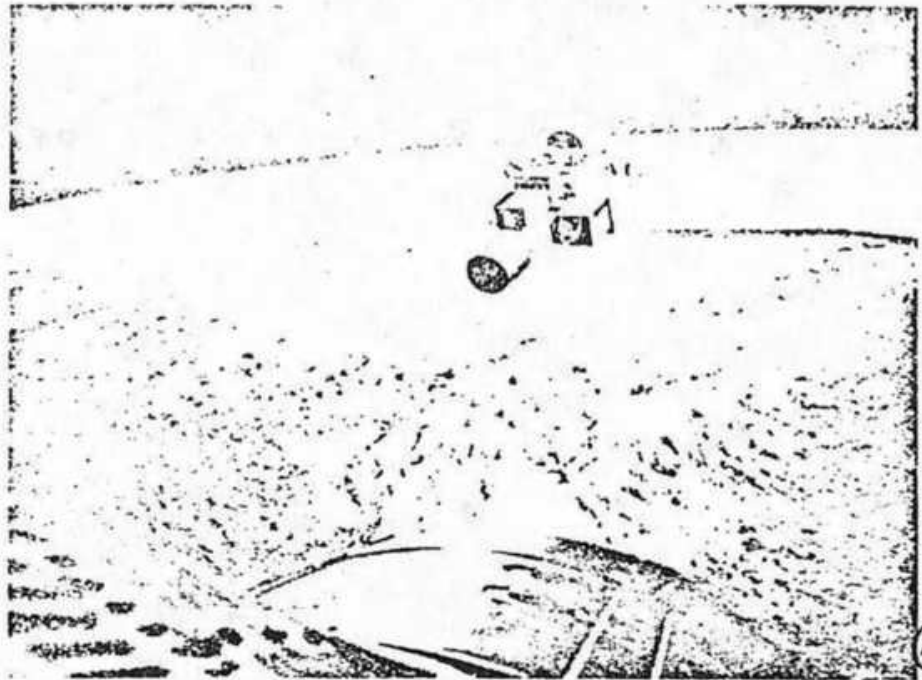
What was it he saw? Why has it become such a prominent UFO case?

And if the pictures did not turn out, where did NICAP get its "top four" photograph (which shows, not a winged cylinder, but a smeared blob)? We can answer these questions at last.

The first hint as to the true identity of this space UFO can be found in McDivitt's own words, given at a press conference a week after the flight when his memory was fresh: "It looked a lot like an upper stage of a booster". Gemini does have a booster just like it, and McDivitt had been carrying out maneuvers near it early in the flight. Why didn't the list from NORAD include the Gemini-4 booster rocket?

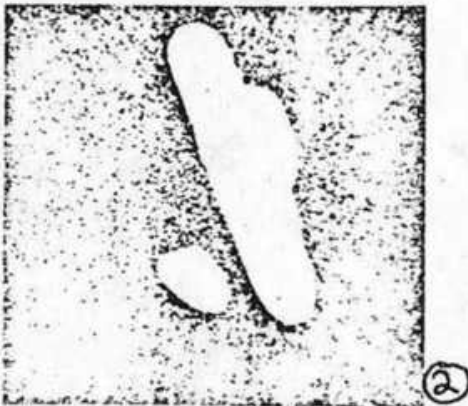
NORAD had been tracking the objects, but NASA had not asked about Gemini-4 and its own associated debris—it had asked about Gemini-4 and any other *earlier* satellites. Anyone familiar with computerized information systems (one of my professional specialties) can guess what happened: the computer was given a "query" which told it to compare Gemini-4 with the other satellites. The computer never knew where the Gemini booster was relative to the spacecraft, since it had not been asked. McDivitt had been visually tracking the thirty foot long cylinder at a range of only 75 miles a few hours earlier, but this large satellite never made the "NORAD list" because

Artist's rendition of the astronauts' view of the rendezvous evaluation pod after it has been jettisoned from the Gemini adaptor section. Gemini radar locked on to evaluation pod.

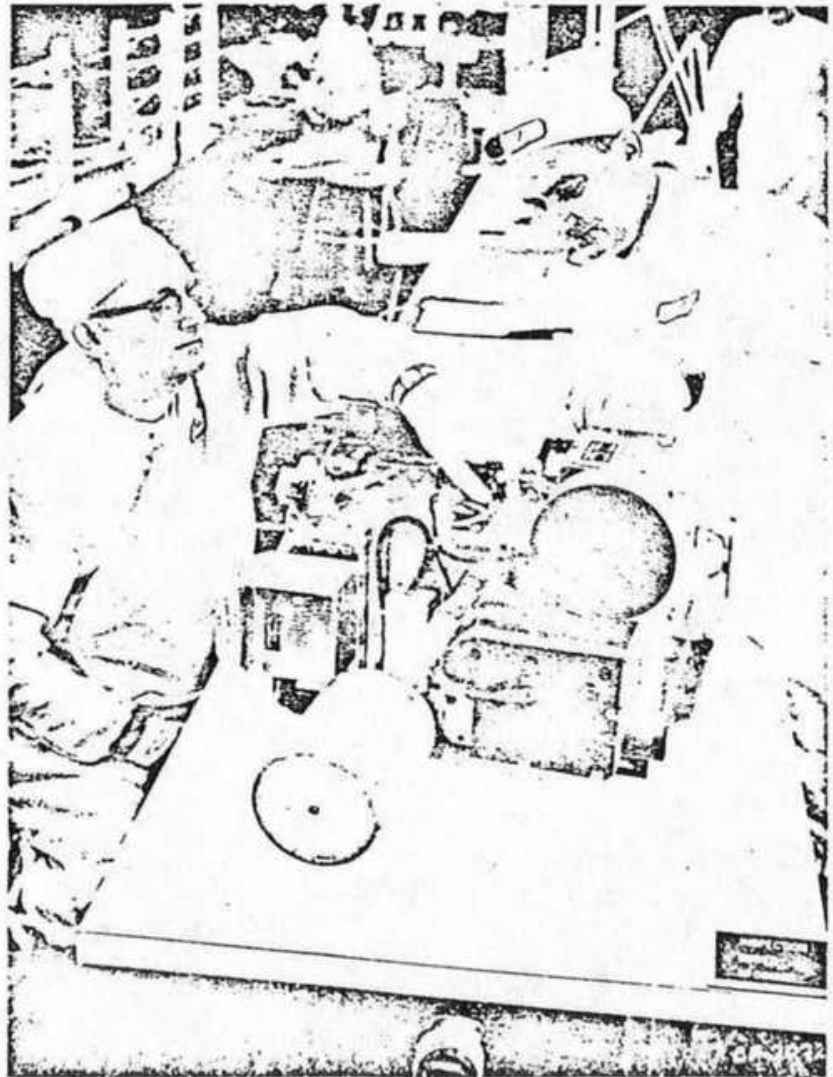


Scott Carpenter took this photo of a subsatellite balloon jettisoned by his Mercury-7 capsule in 1963. Balloon did not inflate and looked like a limp sleeve. Compare with photo S65-45672. UFO researcher George Fawcett has convinced many that this actually shows a "classical domed UFO" accompanied by smaller scout craft; fictional statements by astronaut Carpenter have been quoted.

↓ see plate 21 for full photo blowup



Actual Gemini-5 photo (blowup of S65-45672) of the pod at a range of several hundred feet. The glare and the graininess of the enlarged image give the subsatellite a "blob" appearance and even make it look like two objects. The potato-shaped grey blob is the pod's insulation blanket.



Space engineers at Cape Kennedy prepare the "rendezvous evaluation pod" sub-satellite for a joint flight with the Gemini-5 spacecraft in 1965.

This sequence of pictures illustrates the problem of identifying photographs of objects in the glare of space.



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Gemini-4 photo of 30-foot long Titan booster rocket nearby in orbit; Fuzziness (a familiar space photo effect) is due to magnification. McDivitt later saw the booster again but failed to recognize it, giving rise to the most impressive UFO case in history. NASA S-65-35452.

nobody thought to ask about it! The list was incomplete!

What we do know from the complete Gemini-4 transcripts (including the *on-board* tape recorder as well as space-to-ground links), is that the UFO appeared at the same point in the Gemini orbit where the booster had been repeatedly spotted earlier in the flight. McDivitt had once described seeing his booster with straps hanging from it. Furthermore, on at least one occasion on the first day, McDivitt had at first been unable to recognize the booster when he saw it because it was close to the glare of the sun! This had been at a range of less than ten miles.

Yet another important factor unknown to the Condon report was that McDivitt was complaining to the flight surgeon about his eyesight during this phase of the flight. His eyes

were red and teary due to a reaction with the cabin atmosphere and an accidental massive urine spill. "I didn't think I was going to be able to hack it", McDivitt later had radioed to Earth.

This famous UFO case now becomes that of a pilot with watering eyes catching sight of an object in parallel orbit, an object which he had already misidentified a few hours earlier. As to the photograph, an investigator must go through all the film of the flight to realize how common such blobs of light (overexposures, reflections, glare, etc.) were. Both NASA and McDivitt have agreed that the sequence of movie frames are a view out the window, showing sunlight reflecting off a belt against the dirty window glass. NICAP thinks differently because of the back of its copy of the photo is a handwritten

note (nobody known by whom) stating that McDivitt (nobody knows when) had communicated (nobody knows how) the fact that the picture showed "his UFO". (This was made clear by a telephone conversation between the author and Jack Acuff of NICAP on March 5, 1976).

Why has this case achieved such notoriety? It probably resulted from the enthusiasm of UFO believers, the naive openness of NASA public relations officials, and the publicity-seeking opportunism of some of the principals.

McDivitt himself did little to clear the case up, instead using it as a ticket onto national TV talk shows and news interviews (especially after his retirement in 1967). To add to the mystery, the former spaceman asserts, "I have never been able to identify it, and I don't think anyone ever will."

On a recent "UFO recording" released by Columbia, called "UFOs: The Credibility Factor", McDivitt clearly shows how his memories have changed or been changed to enhance the mystery of his experience: "They (NASA) checked NORAD...to see what they had up on radar and there wasn't anything within very close range of us." Readers can measure the credibility of this statement against the facts.

If McDivitt was fooled by his own booster ten years ago, is it too much to expect him to admit it now? What would that do to all of his public assertions of mystery? There is an easier way out, and McDivitt took it when I sent him an advance copy of my manuscript. After keeping it two months, he wrote back, "I was not able to read it very thoroughly and I cannot offer any extensive comments. I do not foresee the opportunity for me to provide any further review." There weren't any errors in my analysis, he implied, but it would be better kept quiet.

NASA never had any real doubts. "We believe it to be a rocket tank or spent second stage of a rocket," wrote a high space official on July 1, 1965. NORAD officials, confronted with my scenario, endorsed it: "Your comments on the NORAD role related to the case appear to be logical," wrote NORAD Public Information Officer D.W. Kindschi on Feb. 23, 1976.

So the "McDivitt case" is closed. The best space UFO case has now been identified. Do not expect to see any change in the UFO press, however. Such results are simply ignored.

Photographs made in space show negative effects, such as the "McDivitt UFO" aura, often. Spacecraft and astronauts may be engulfed in a strange aura caused by overexposure to sunlight brighter than ever seen on Earth. Blowups of photographs of known space objects show them appearing as "blobs" due to the enlargement process and to the coarseness of the grain. Ordinary space pictures are full of clouds of debris, constellations of man-made starlike points fluttering through space.

The Condon report was fascinated with the McDivitt case, and few UFO enthusiasts have not heard of it. But neither the Condon researchers nor the average reader had ever had all the facts. Now people can make up their

own minds. I have no doubt that McDivitt was seeing his own Titan booster stage.

Dr. Roach was also fascinated with another McDivitt sighting, that of a point of light crossing the sky. The object sounded just like the appearance of an artificial earth satellite, and that is exactly what McDivitt thought it was. There is no information to suggest it was anything else.

Another Condon favorite is a Gemini-7 case. The report of sightings of a cloud of debris right at the moment of booster separation (these particles included frozen fuel droplets, the booster itself, assorted insulation and structural fragments from where the explosive bolts were fired, and other smaller objects never identified and never cared about) is not very impressive. The crew, on their first space mission, saw a few pieces they had not expected (the pilot guessed—wrongly—that they "were in polar orbit"). Only a partisan digging for evidence, and desperate to find such evidence, would make much of this common event.

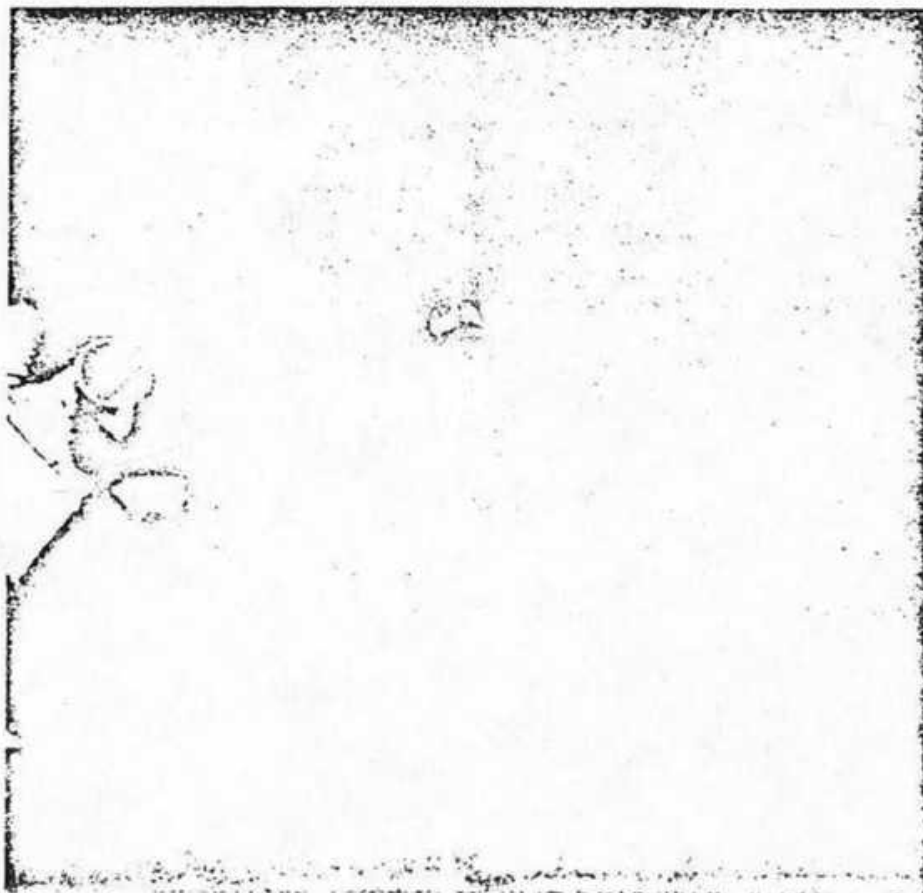
But a sign of desperation is indeed

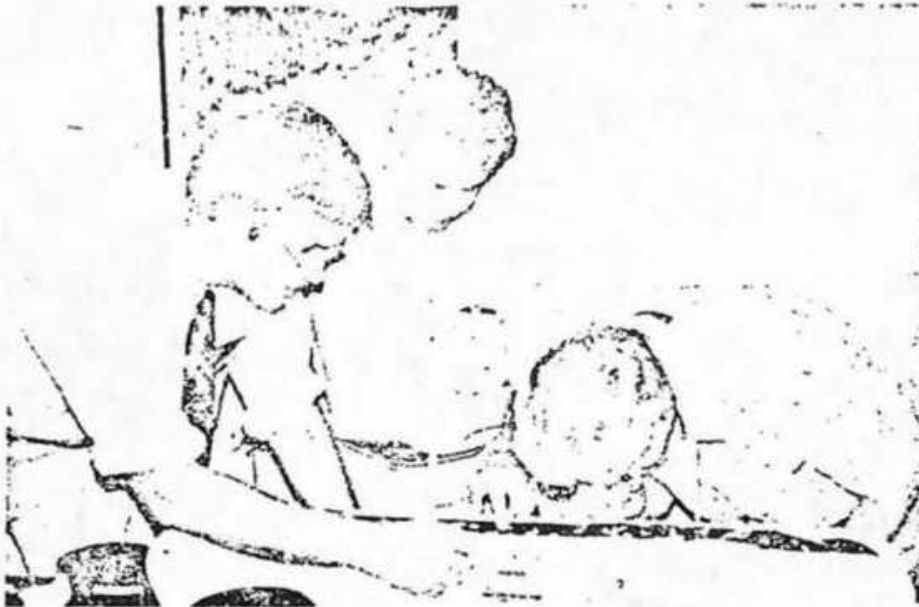
found in connection with the Gemini-7 UFO case. It is not the desperation of government officials trying to cover up the truth about UFOs. Rather, it is the desperation of some outsider trying to manufacture counter-foil "astronaut UFO" evidence, an activity which should not be necessary if the "real" UFO evidence were as persuasive as many think.

It involves a photograph showing two very strange glowing objects. Each is hexagonal in shape, viewed at an angle, and supported by a dazzling "force field" below it. A cloud-covered earth is seen in the background. See plates 27 & 28

This photograph has appeared in books, magazines, newspapers, and pamphlets. It is part of the travelling slide show of UFO lecturers from the Mutual UFO Network (MUFON) and elsewhere. I have heard it described as "showing a typical UFO force field propulsion system", and "similar to other UFO photograph taken on Earth the same year".

The photograph is a forgery. It is a hoax. What the anonymous counterfeiter did (I have reason to suspect a





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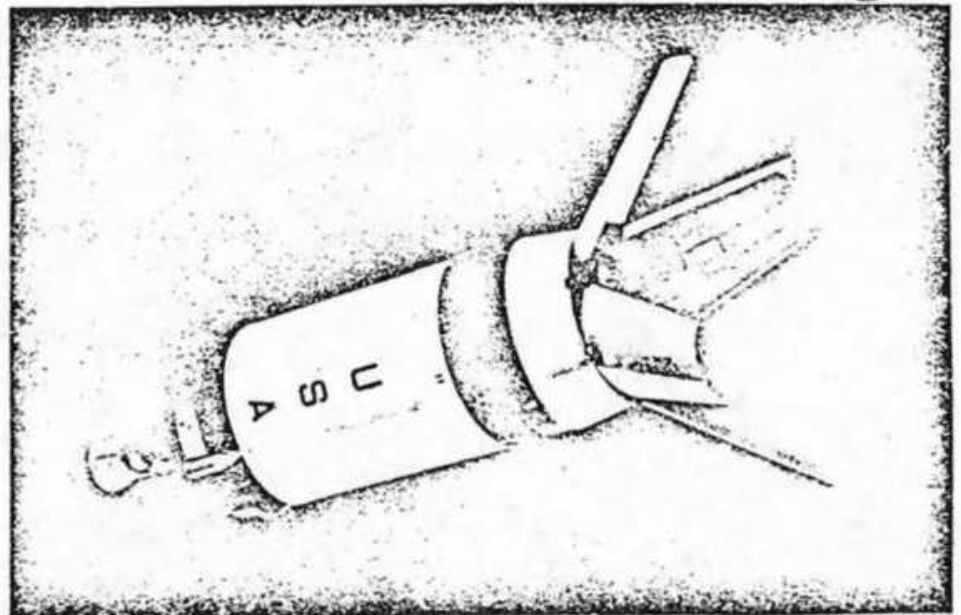
The author and NASA photo analyst Richard Underwood show "space UFO" photos to Dr. J. Allen Hynek, director of the center for UFO studies, July, 1976. Hynek subsequently endorsed Oberg's conclusions.

Saturn booster S-IV-b and four open "SLA" panels. On moon flights the four "petals" fly free and, together with the empty booster, tumble through space a few miles from the Apollo capsule. They were often seen as bright flashing lights as they reflected the powerful sunlight. On Apollo-12, astronaut descriptions of these fragments were misinterpreted by UFO buffs and metamorphized into alien spacecraft.

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"Mysterious" bulls eye object seen and photographed by Gemini-6 astronauts in December, 1965. Unfortunately for flying saucer buffs, it is not a UFO; it is an out of focus photo of the approaching Gemini-7 spaceship, nose on. NASA photo S-65-65296.

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The view from inside early space capsules was limited and often plagued by dirty windows and bright reflections. Gene Cernan, Gemini-9. NASA photo S-66-38024.



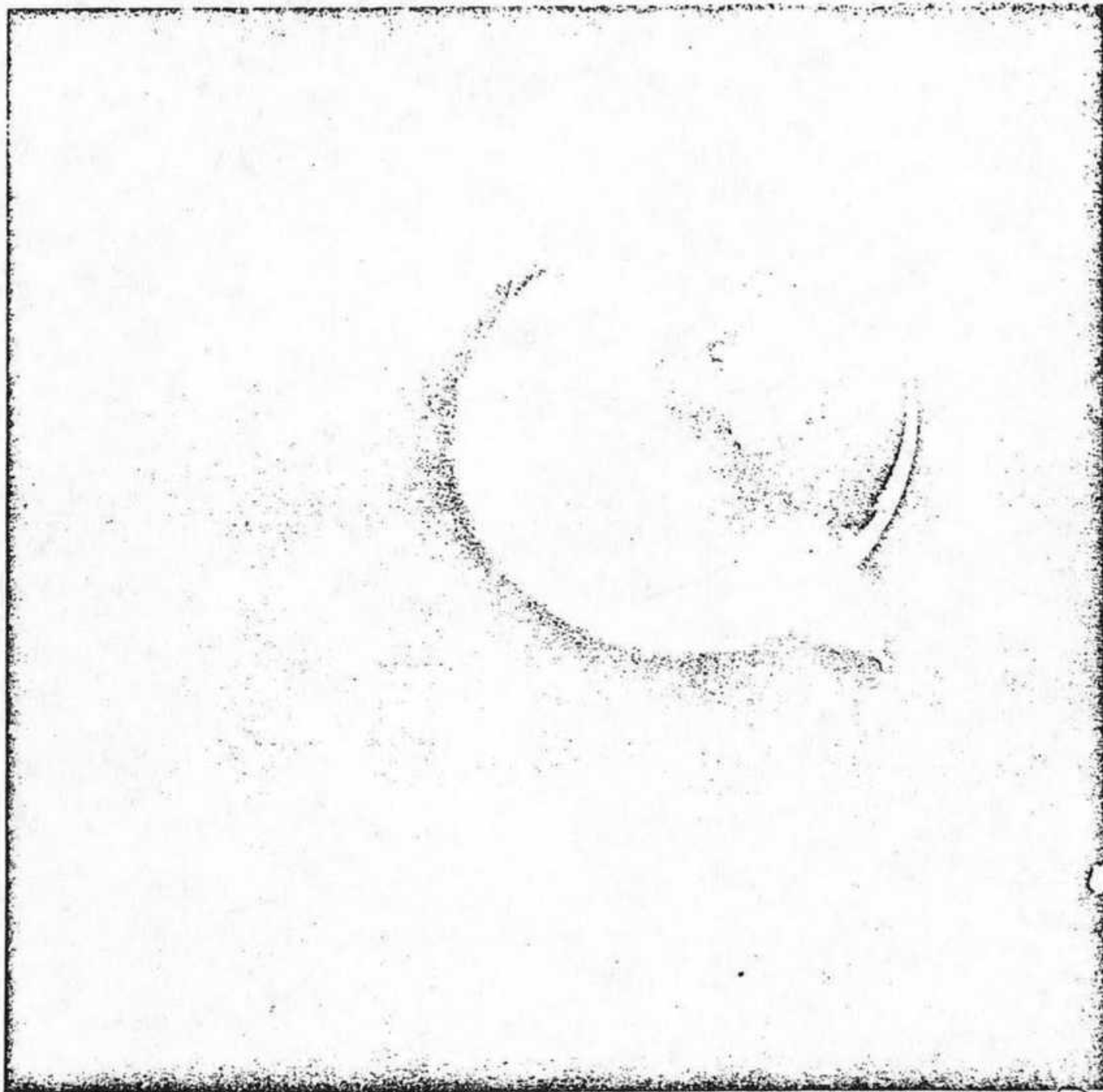


Photo of Gemini-7 from Gemini-6, December 1965. The brightness aura is a common space photo effect and often makes point sources appear to be surrounded by a "force field" or an "exhaust trail". NASA photo S-65-65304. (12)

Japanese UFO organization) was taken an ordinary photograph of Earth made from the Gemini-7 spaceship on December 4, 1965. The nose of the spacecraft fills the lower part of the frame, and on the nose, catching the glare of the sun, is a pair of roll control rocket thrusters used to adjust the attitude and spin rate of the Gemini. The original photo (NASA S65-63722, which I have personally

examined) was then retouched by the unscrupulous hoaxter to eliminate the edge of the nose from view, so the dark surface of the spaceship merged into the dark Earth beneath. This left the two now mysterious lights seemingly suspended in space, as it were. A normal space tourist photo was turned into convincing UFO evidence, and thousands of people were fooled.

American spacemen are not the only ones reporting UFOs, according to the popular press. Stories that allegedly come from Moscow tell about UFOs following Soviet manned spacecraft in the Vostok and Voskhod series ten years ago. But such secrecy surrounds the entire Soviet space effort that these stories cannot be checked out.

That very secrecy, however, is itself

a powerful argument against the validity of the rumors. So many ordinary things about the Soviet space program are secret (and long prison terms await anyone who even accidentally divulges such data) that it is incredible that so sensitive and significant a fact as a UFO sighting could ever leak out, even if such a thing had really happened.

The rules of evidence have been stretched and broken by UFO partisans. It is not up to me to "prove" that these sightings never took place. Nobody has as yet seen any evidence apart from a simple statement of fact that the sightings *did* take place. I will be happy to consider evidence when it becomes available.

Let's examine more of these "cosmonaut UFOs". In *UFOs From Behind The Iron Curtain*, the UFO magazine 'Clypeus' is quoted about an object seen by both Vostok-5 and Vostok-6, a fleet of disks seen by Voskhod-1, and "strange cylinders in space which were perfectly formed and had no apertures" seen by Voskhod-1, Voskhod-2, and Gemini-4 (sic!). UFOs have even been blamed for the malfunction of the Voskhod-2 autopilot. As I have said, these "reports" are hardly evidence, and can be far more easily manufactured than refuted.

Surely one of the most specious and ghoulish "space UFO" stories deals with the Soyuz-11 flight, on which the crewmen perished during their return to Earth. UFO literature has recently been circulating a "transcript" between the cosmonauts and ground control. The crewmen describe several glowing red objects and discuss them with flight controllers.

To anyone familiar with typical space-to-ground communications, this "transcript" is patently counterfeit. Someone's vivid imagination, emboldened by the knowledge that the men were dead and could not argue, must have created the entire incident.

Without further evidence, the entire class of "cosmonaut UFOs" must be rejected. Deliberate attempts to "muddy the waters" and to manufacture fantasies are common in this UFO genre, as in others.

In investigating photographic evidence of UFO sightings by American astronauts, I worked closely with Richard Underwood at the NASA Johnson Space Center (formerly the

Manned Spacecraft Center) near Houston. Underwood is an experienced photointerpreter who has examined every single photograph brought back from orbit and beyond, and his incredible memory can identify a decade old photograph, describe the situation, and find the citation in the old record books within minutes. The office of this photogrametric engineer is full of stacked film cans, light tables, world and local maps, and piles of letters from ex-astronauts and ordinary citizens alike.

Has he seen any UFOs? Underwood answered that with a smile: "I've never found anything in these pictures that puzzled me for long, and I'm kind of disappointed. It would be terribly exciting to find evidence for someone else's spaceship!" When UFO writers hint broadly about a "NASA coverup" or "space censorship", they are essentially calling Dick Underwood and his colleagues a pack of liars.

Distortion and withholding of the truth is not a stranger to Underwood's

office, however. When a UFO researcher named Alan Sandler was working on a book and a movie ("UFOs: Past, Present and Future", to be advertised as a "documentary") he visited Underwood's office and looked through dozens of rolls of film, writing down orders for prints of anything that looked interesting. This is a standard service provided by NASA to journalists.

Sandler chose a set of photographs for his movie, photographs which Underwood advised him probably only showed dust particles in front of the camera, debris outside the spacecraft, or glare on the windows (this was easy enough to prove by looking at pictures ahead of and behind the shots in question). Two photographs were particularly upsetting.

They both showed a black background with a string of lights in the middle of the photograph. In the book (with the same name as the movie, although written by another author, Robert Emeneagar) the two shots are

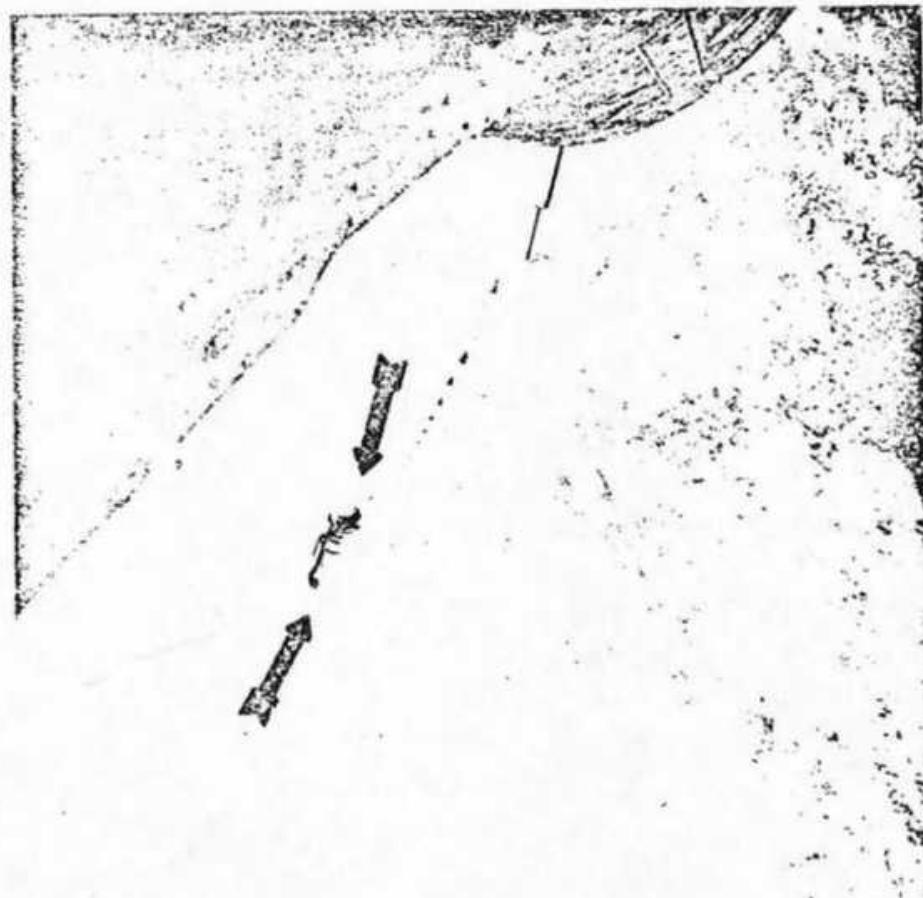
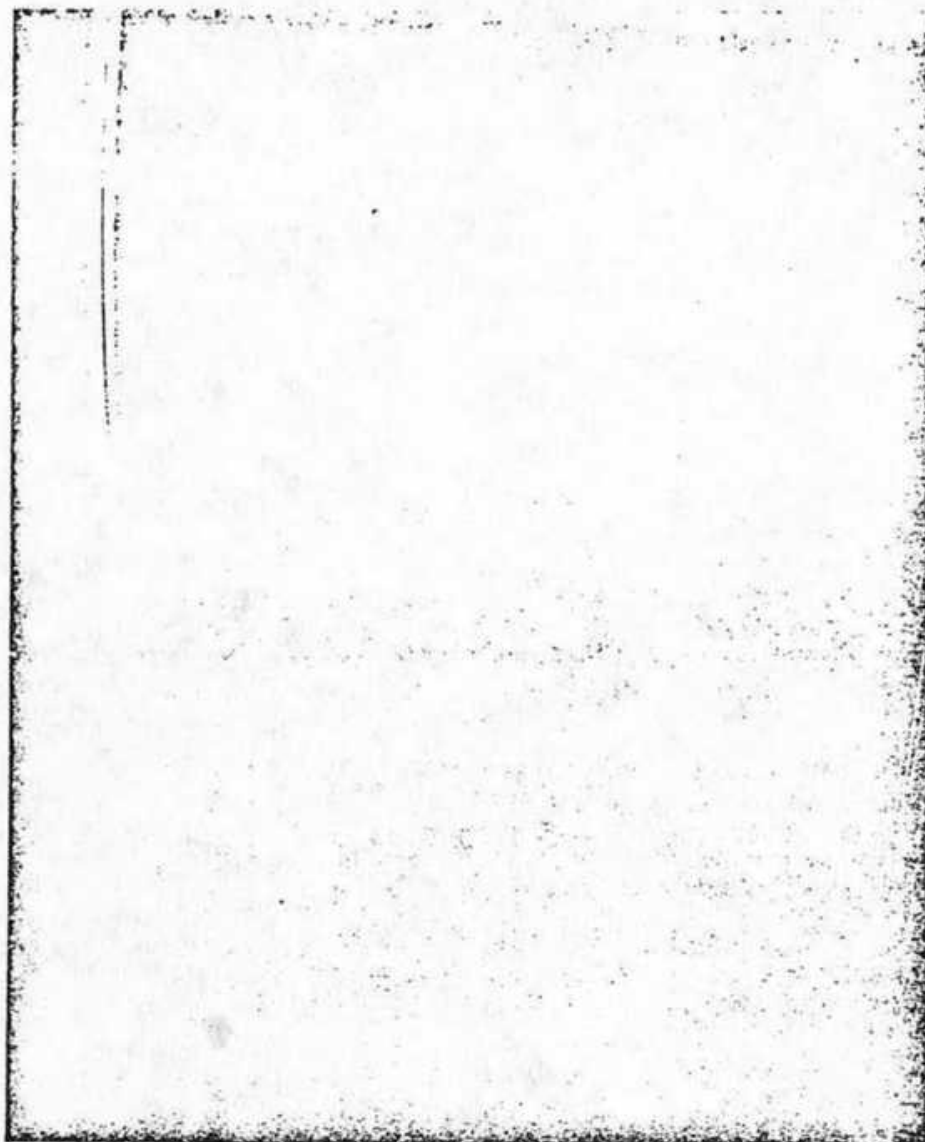


Photo of Agena-12 from Gemini-12. This is part of a sequence of photos which takes the Agena from light into dark. After dark, only the running lights are visible. One researcher has widely published this latter photograph as a "UFO". "said by NASA to be Agena tracking lights". NASA photo S-66-63101.



"Said to be ranging lights" on Gemini-12, according to Sandler. Compare with earlier photo showing Agena in the sunlight. Deliberate slanting of evidence.

reproduced with the caption: "Shot during Gemini XII on November 13, 1966, and said to be Agena Ranging Lights prior to docking". The erroneous implication of these twisted words is that this is another NASA excuse for some remarkable UFO photographs. Said to be ranging lights, indeed, sneers the book!

"That's exactly what they were!" Underwood told me plaintively. "They are part of the complete sequence of twenty photographs showing the Agena as it moves from the sunlit side of Earth into the shadow".

As Underwood and I stood in the photo laboratory inside building No. 8 at the historic Houston space center, the sequence was right there in front of our eyes on the glowing viewing board. How did the "UFO researcher" react to this explanation, I asked?

He continued to explain: "I took the whole sequence with me to Hollywood along with other films which NASA was providing. I showed the sequence to Sandler. He wasn't interested. Unfortunately he went ahead and used the photographs anyway". Thousands more people were deceived.

The flight of Gemini-11 began a long battle between astronaut Charles "Pete" Conrad and UFO believers. The astronauts had taken three even more remarkable photographs. "Pete" Conrad had spotted a moving object outside his window and had snapped off a few frames of film, varying the exposure on each shot in an attempt to get at least one good view which would show something.

Per a request from NASA, NORAD soon reported that the object had been

a Russian cosmic ray laboratory called Proton-3. According to Air Force computers, it would have crossed Gemini's orbit several hundred miles behind the spacecraft. Yet this object was in a different direction and was much too close. It was a UFO!

Despite these objections, NORAD was right for the wrong reasons. The object was indeed Proton-3, even though the Aerial Phenomenon Research Organization (APRO) and its research director, Dr. James Harder, has made much of the discrepancy and considers this the best Gemini UFO ever seen. (see ptes 17, 18, 19, 23, 24)

Few researchers have noticed, and none had recognized the significance of the fact, that the Proton-3 satellite was only hours away from burning up in the atmosphere. As its orbit decayed toward a fiery doom, it circled Earth faster and faster, running ahead of the schedule predicted by NORAD.

The simple truth, often ignored or distorted by many writers, is that NORAD does *not* "track everything in space" like the radar screens of some air traffic control center. Instead, objects which pass through the beams of a handful of worldwide radar sites (at a range of a thousand miles or less) are observed and catalogued, and their orbits are calculated. These calculations are then projected forward in time (the mathematical term is "extrapolated") to plot where the spacecraft should be if its orbit hasn't been changed.

Gemini's orbit had been changed by a rendezvous rocket firing. Proton's orbit was changed by its decay. I ordered microfilm copies of the last few NORAD predictions from the Tracking Reports Section at the NASA Goddard Space Center in Greenbelt, Maryland, and as soon as I read them I knew the answer.

The predictions were off by several hundred miles per day! Each new projection made a correction to the previous one. Using a combination of these figures, a new altitude difference between Gemini and Proton could easily be computed. It was entirely close enough to coincide with the astronauts' sighting.

Furthermore, the astronauts had made a visual as well as a photographic record. Their eyewitness testimony describes a satellite that looks like Proton-3 looked, as shown by exhibits in Russian museums: a stubby cylinder

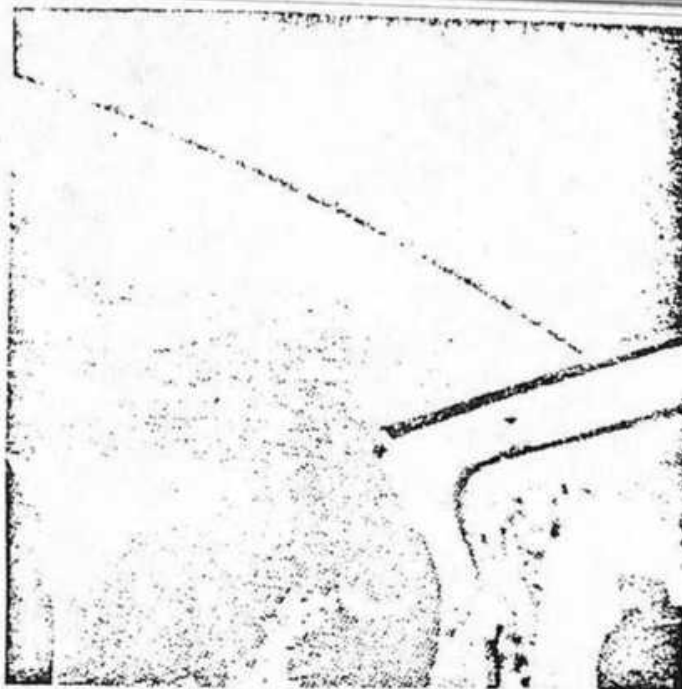
with four large triangular canted solar panels. (Conrad compared the sight to the strap-on boosters of a Titan-3 rocket.) Even the photographs show this when studied with real Proton-3 photographs close at hand.

Astronaut Conrad and the UFO people clashed again over his next space mission, Apollo-12. According to the Research Director of APRO, Dr. Harder, Conrad reported that he was being followed by a UFO on the way to the moon. Conrad claims that it was just a joke about the large panels which enclose the lunar module during launch but are jettisoned later in the flight and which tumble through space a few miles from the Apollo all the way to the moon. Harder says that Conrad, under pressure from a secret government agency, is lying.

These are Conrad's words: "They've been after me for years because we were followed by a UFO on the way to the moon. That, of course, was untrue. The guy who came up with it was going by our transcript where we saw debris from our own rocket and we were joking with the ground crew about it. He took this out of context. . . I called the ground and said, 'hey, gang, we're being followed, there's some flashing object out there'. Some scandal sheet took that and

Debris from open hatch on Gemini-12.

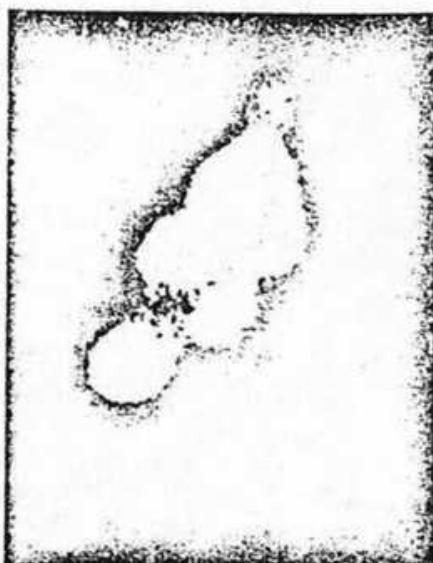
(16)



Fragment in focus at range of 3 to 5 feet—Sandler calls it "unidentifiable", and Mallan and Barry also use it.

(enlargement of 16)

(15)

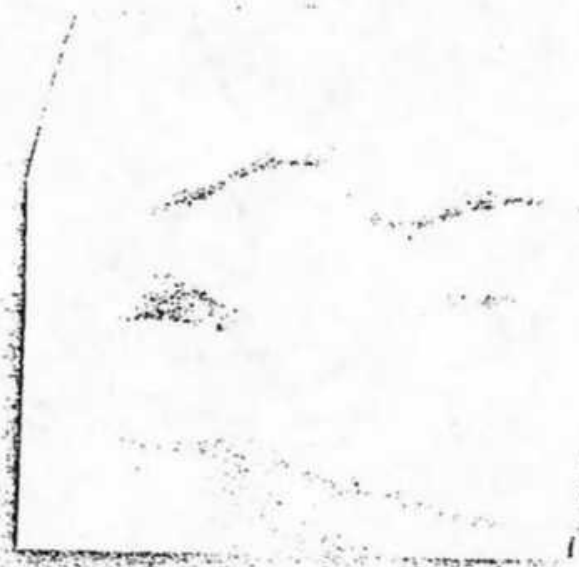


(17) (18)

Blowups of Gemini-11 photos of Proton-3. Sun glare and extreme magnification contribute to bizarre appearance.

made a helluva story out of it. But it was nothing like anything I was connected with". Conrad has left NASA and lives in Denver, presumably beyond the reach of any NASA censors. He describes a phenomenon common to all Apollo moon flights; the claim that he saw a UFO is also common, but hardly as valid.

Conrad confirmed these quotations in a letter to me dated April 12, 1976. "I hope your paper is widely printed," he added. Referring to Harder's claim of coverup, Conrad could only say: "I think you have more than your share of Kooks."



Gemini-11 photo of Proton-3 (arrow) and extreme enlargement of image. UFO magazines often print fuzzy blobs without indicating that object was highly magnified. Film artifacts cause "blobbiness". NASA photo S-66-54661.

19

Let's take a moment to look at the Apollo-12 flight more carefully. It probably rates as one of the most "UFO-ridden" space flights ever made, and probably did more than any Apollo mission to encourage the stories of astronaut sightings of UFOs. What lies behind all these stories? Who started them? What is the "official" NASA position?

Apollo-12 was launched on November 14, 1969, on the second moon landing mission. The crew consisted of Gemini-11 veterans "Pete" Conrad and Richard Gordon, and space rookie Alan Bean (Conrad

had also flown into space on Gemini-5.) Taking off during a thunderstorm, the craft was twice hit by lightning which threatened to abort the mission.

Instead, the flight proceeded successfully to the first pinpoint moon landing four days later. Astronauts Conrad and Bean flew their Lunar Module in to a precision touchdown near the Surveyor-3 automatic moon probe. During a scheduled moon walk, the men retrieved samples from the robot craft. The return on Earth was "routine", if flights to the moon can ever be considered routine.

On the outbound leg, Conrad had radioed to Earth that the Apollo was "being followed". This message, transmitted over the open radio link, was heard by hundreds of newsmen and by millions of Americans. It immediately gave rise to new UFO stories.

According to the account best known to UFO believers (published in *Saga* magazine, May 1970, entitled "Apollo 12's Mysterious Encounter with Flying Saucers", written by T.G. Beckley and H. Salkin), the astronauts watched two flashing lights near their Command Module about 150,000 miles out from Earth. At first, the



Apollo-11 UFO, 1969. Object tumbled past window immediately after Apollo pulled away from Saturn booster. Metamorphosis of obvious spacecraft insulation fragment into "odd-shaped UFO" is courtesy of Bob Barry of the fringe "20th Century UFO Bureau".

Hans Holzer's "Ufonauts" (1976) assigns object to John Glenn's flight, invents fictitious commentary and continues weaving myths unfettered by facts.

↓ goes with plate 21

(20)

ground thought it was their S-IV-B booster rocket but quickly calculated that it would have been in a different direction. Next, they suggested that the lights could have been pieces of the Lunar Module "garage", called "SLA Panels", which are quite large and highly reflective. Conrad, so the UFO story goes, remarked that this was unlikely since one of them had suddenly taken off at a high velocity, something that a piece of space debris simply could not do. Finally, the

astronauts decided to ignore the apparently harmless escort and carry on with their mission

In lunar orbit, new (or perhaps the same) UFOs dogged the spacemen. During the descent to the lunar surface, millions of television watchers on Earth saw bright objects crossing the field of view of the Apollo TV cameras. Similar objects were seen during the launch from the moon and during the final approach to Earth.

Here, then, is a major case for

"astronaut UFO sightings". Besides the three astronauts, millions of Americans saw the TV images and heard the voices of the crewmen wondering what the objects could be. They were obviously unidentified, they were flying in space, and they were objects of some sort. Hence, they were UFOs.

The "Fawcett List" of space UFOs says that the astronauts "said a UFO accompanied them all the way to within 132,000 miles of the moon,



Mercury-7. "Comed UFO" on Scott Carpenter's flight in 1963. Smears and glares change from one frame to the next while astronaut was snapping pictures of limp balloon sub-satellite.

see plates 2,3,4,5

(21)



Two objects drifting out of open hatch (lower right) of Gemini-12. Both specks are out of focus and hence are within several feet of camera. —which had a very large depth of field. Object on right, in focus, is a scrap of paper. NASA photo S-66-62871.

preceding them all the way." The origin of that mileage figure is obscure, but it lends unwarranted authenticity to the report.

Observatories in Europe also watched the two UFOs, other sources reveal. Embellishing the story, another UFO source claims that "Next day, the 15th, at 21.15 hours, one bright

revolving light approached the Apollo 12 spacecraft." Fawcett, not to be outdone, also claims that the astronauts photographed the UFO (or UFOs).

One of the loudest proponents of the Apollo-12 UFO is APRO research director Dr. James Harder. At a UFO symposium at the University of

California at Santa Cruz on November 8, 1975, Harder claimed that one UFO "followed Apollo 12 on three orbits around the moon". Further, "NASA suppressed the UFO incidents for fear of panic", but Harder was able to discover the sightings because it "was disclosed by a member of the space team" who he refused to identify.

Since all the material Harder used to "prove" the existence of the incidents were public information (Harder could have read it in *Saga*, which is hardly a top secret government report), his reference to a coverup and to secret inside information were clearly only gimmicks to impress the news media with the value of his "information".

NASA, meanwhile, says that no such UFO event took place. The lights, according to Dale Myers (Associate Administrator for Manned Space Flight: quoted in a letter dated Feb. 5, 1973 to Mr. Donald Ratsch of APRO), were spacecraft fragments: "During all of our Apollo lunar missions, objects have been sighted by the various crews. Subsequent to the crew sightings, the flight controllers determined the observations were probably either the S-IVB booster, the spacecraft lunar adapter (SLA) panels, or smaller objects such as mylar foil particles. Because of their large size and highly reflective surfaces, the S-IVB and SLA panels should be visible at great distances in the space environment..."

Astronaut Conrad, as quoted earlier, claimed that the flashing lights were obviously SLA panels but that he was joking with the ground. He denounced the *Saga* story explicitly and gave his opinion that Harder was a "kook". Astronaut Gordon has publicly stated that he has never seen a UFO on any space flight. Alan Bean, the only one of the three still on active NASA duty, issued a statement soon after Harder's latest charges went out over the news media late in 1975. In a UPI dispatch:

"Astronaut Alan Bean... said that at no time during his mission did he ever see an unidentified object. Bean said that there were some metallic parts which floated behind their spacecraft after the Apollo-12 lunar module lifted off from the moon. He said these small pieces were visible until they (the astronauts) made an engine burn. The metallic objects were parts of the insulation which came off the lunar module during the launch phase and lunar orbital phase. 'At no time did we see anything which was not of our spacecraft, either during lunar orbit or during the voyage to and from the moon,' Bean stated."

To Harder and his "NASA coverup", these statements are just more lies designed to confuse the American public. So let's go back to

the key Apollo-12 UFO encounter and try to determine just who is confused.

Late on November 15th, 1969, about 150,000 statute miles from Earth, the Apollo crew was talking to capsule communicator astronaut Gerald Carr about some lights they were watching out their window.

Apollo: The object is very bright and it is obviously something that is tumbling. It is tumbling (at) one and one half rev(olution)s per second, or at least it is flashing at us (at) about that (rate)...

CAPCOM: Roger. We are standing by.

CAPCOM: (Apollo) 12, (this is) Houston.

Apollo: Go ahead.

CAPCOM: As best we can tell, looking at things down here, on those SLA panels, we assume they weren't imparted with any great amount of delta-V (velocity change)—like anything more than one or so feet per second when they separated (thirty-three hours ago). Your SLA panels would probably be only about 300 (nautical) miles (345 statute miles) away from you right now.

**** The following reply by Conrad has been claimed by UFO believers to indicate that the lights (the so-called "SLA panels") have suddenly pulled away from the Apollo, something that a tumbling piece of debris could not do. To clarify the meaning, punctuation and a few extra parenthetical words have been added by the UFOlogists:

Apollo: That could be true, but gee whiz, when I (just) turned around I saw one of those "SLA panels" leaving the area at a high rate of speed, and it looked to me like it was leaving us pretty (fast)—at a pretty rapid clip, like it got a lot more than a foot per second or so.

CAPCOM: Well, since we don't really have any idea how they left, or what their trajectory could be, it's kind of tough really to say just what the heck that could be.

Apollo: Okay. We'll assume it's friendly anyway. OK?

The UFO reasoning, as worded by APRO member Brad Sparks, goes as follows: "After the SLA panels separated and the S-IVB's tanks were emptied (on Nov. 14) they could not change their velocity simply because they had no form of propulsion to do so. But Conrad saw one of the "SLA panels" (on Nov. 15th) suddenly leave

its position at a "high rate of speed", an impossibility, unless it really was a maneuverable spacecraft of some sort. But where does one find a maneuverable spacecraft nearly 150,000 miles from the earth? The answer: (excepting Apollo 12 itself) in November of 1969 there weren't any. The conclusion is inescapable: One (possibly two) maneuverable spacecraft *not* of man-made origin were following our Apollo 12 on November 14 and 15, 1969."

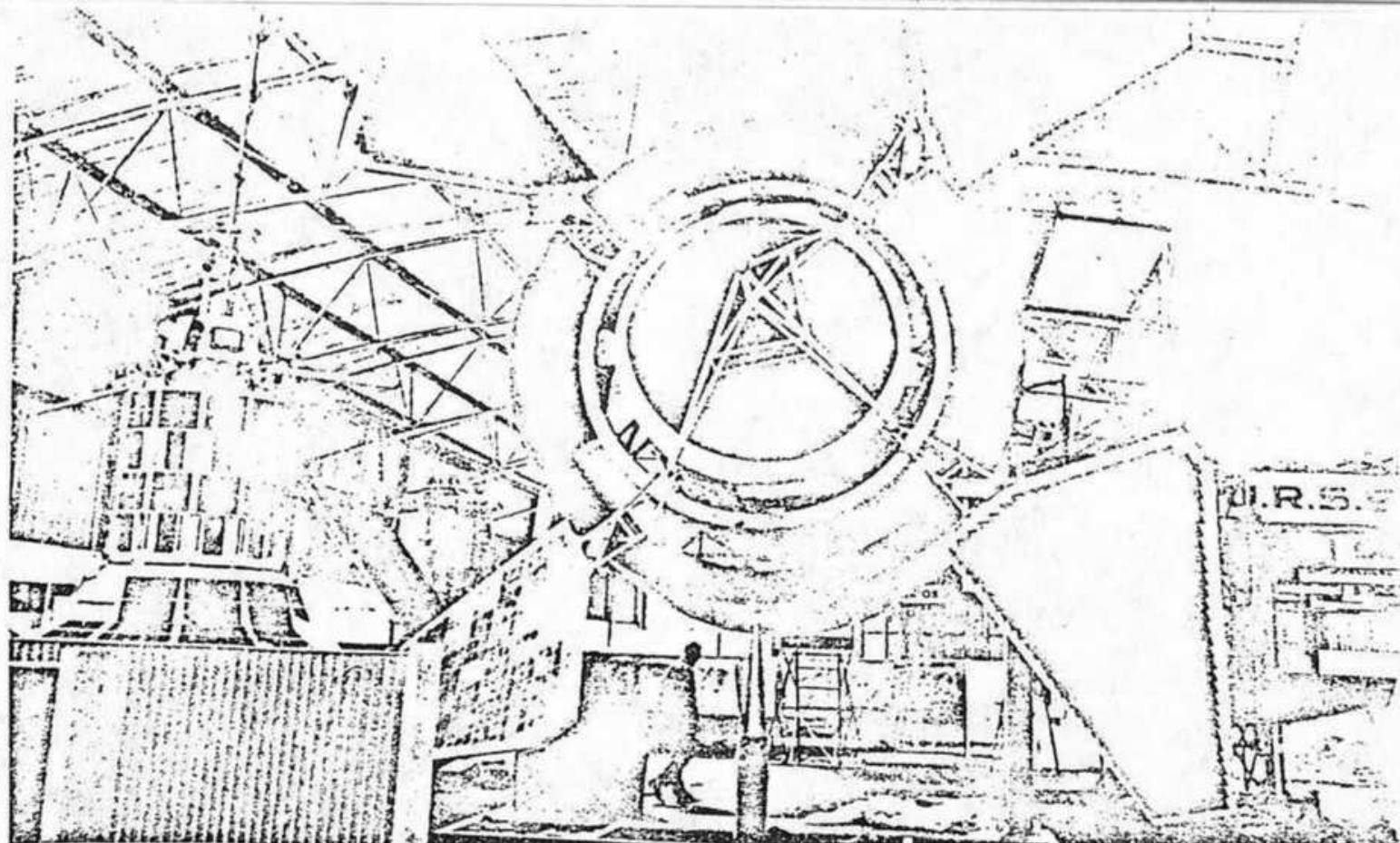
To anyone familiar with the flight plan of an Apollo moon flight, Conrad's words imply nothing of the sort. Two facts must be brought to mind. First, Apollo and the Capcom were discussing the present position of the SLA panels based upon their initial separation velocities from the spent S-IVB rocket stage. Second, the SLA panels break free after the Apollo pulls off from the booster; the astronauts then perform a maneuver called the "turnaround" the Command Module returns to the booster to dock with the now-exposed Lunar Module, before pulling the LM free from its "garage".

Striking the UFOlogist's punctuation and clarifying words from the communication, and putting it in proper perspective, what Conrad was saying was:

Apollo: That could be true (that the SLA panels were flying off at one or so feet per second), but gee whiz, when I turned around (right after they flew free, thirty-three hours ago) I saw one of those SLA panels leaving the area (of the LM "garage") at a high rate of speed, and it looked to me that it was leaving us pretty... at a pretty rapid clip, like it got a lot more than a foot per second or so.

The UFO believers' reasoning—and the entire basis for Harder's and for the *Saga* article's Apollo-12 UFO sighting—is phony. The most generous description of it would be a mistake, a misreading of the transcript's meaning in an attempt to "prove" a UFO incident that never really happened outside of the fertile imaginations of certain UFO believers. Conrad's statement, Gordon's statement, Bean's statement, and the NASA letter must stand validated on this case: Apollo-12 was not followed by a UFO on its to the moon.

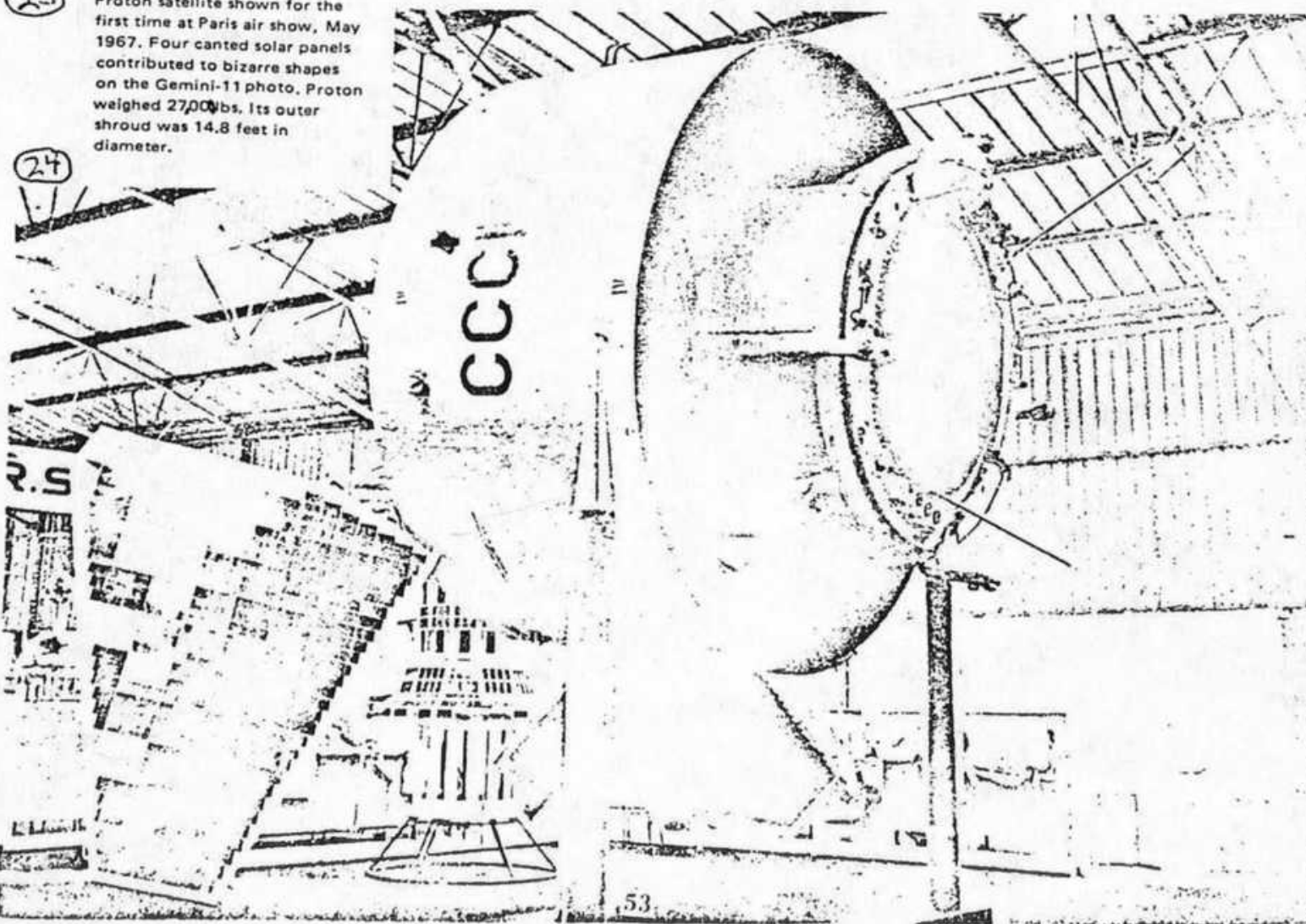
But how about on the way back? "A light of indistinct shape" was spotted just prior to re-entry,



(23)

Proton satellite shown for the first time at Paris air show, May 1967. Four canted solar panels contributed to bizarre shapes on the Gemini-11 photo. Proton weighed 27,000 lbs. Its outer shroud was 14.8 feet in diameter.

(24)





Published newspaper story on UFOs captions this photo: "These two UFOs were photographed on July 19, 1969—the day before Apollo's historic moon landing—during Buzz Aldrin's scheduled lunar photo session. Note the similarity to the shot snapped three years earlier during Gemini-12."

according to UFO sources. *Saga* reports that "...at 11:47 a.m. on November 24th, the spokesman for Apollo 12 reported in a startled voice that they were all watching a bright red object flashing brilliantly against the earth." This incident was carefully analyzed by Brad Sparks of APRO (I am indebted to his letter to *Saga* of August 28, 1970, a letter *Saga* editor never bothered to answer), who objects that "the astronauts did not report that the object they were seeing was red, and they stated specifically that 'it's a steady light', not flashing." It was seen between them and the dark earth, somewhere off the coast of India by a guess of the crewmen. Perhaps it was a ship's searchlight, perhaps a fire, perhaps a violent lightning storm... there is no reason to suspect that it was a craft in space. The astronauts lost sight of the light as they turned the Apollo to take a series of photographs of the sunrise.

The wild fantasies printed in *Saga* do not end here. Beckley and Salkin claim that the astronauts had been "startled by unaccountable seismic disturbances on the lunar surface." This event never occurred; there were no such earthquakes during their visit.

Beckley and Salkin refer to "a mysterious blue halo encircling one of our spacemen." Sparks of APRO considers this to have been lunar dust kicked up while the crewmen were walking around. Photo analyst Dick Underwood suggested that it is a defect in the development of the photo caused by the vivid solar glare off of a highly reflective surface; Underwood quickly located half a dozen similar "haloes" on other space

photos taken during the 1960s. Whatever it was, this "halo" appeared only in the photo, and was neither seen nor remarked on by the astronauts.

Houston radio commentator and UFO enthusiast Frank Haley has his own theory about why the Apollo-12 TV camera did not work on the moon (NASA says Bean accidentally pointed it toward the sun). Says Haley, "The camera was intentionally shut off to avoid showing something on the moon that disturbed the astronauts" ("Haley's Comment" newsletter, Mar. 22, 1976). It is only a matter of time before this nonsense is absorbed into the lore of the "Apollo-12 UFOs".

But Apollo 12 *did* see some unidentified flying objects, and NASA engineers were justifiably concerned that they could have been debris from important spacecraft systems which might indicate unexpected failures, or which might interfere with other spacecraft equipment. Hence, the Manned Spacecraft Center in Houston (now the Johnson Space Center) gave a contract to Lockheed to study the objects seen on the TV pictures and on some movie film.

The Lockheed report was quietly issued on March 18, 1970, about the same time that the sensationalized and fictionalized *Saga* story was being printed. Titled "Unidentified Visual Phenomena Associated with Space Flight" (NASA Contract NAS 9-5191, LEC/HASD No. 671-80-013), the report documents the "moon pigeons" (a term "coined by NASA engineers to describe unexpected objects seen in operational photography that defy positive identification") of Apollo-12.

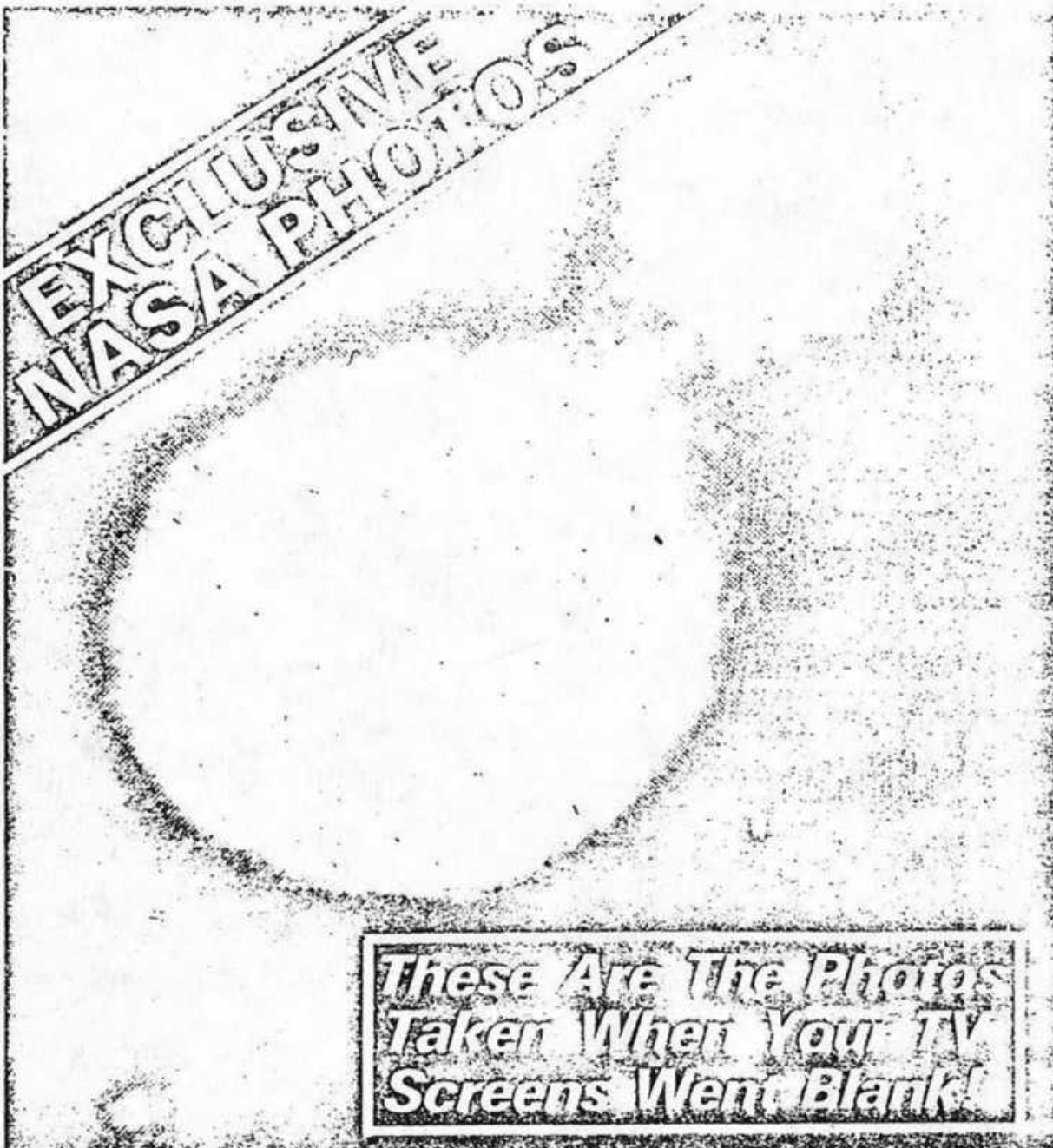
Contract engineers were F.D. Beatty and J.G. Baron.

"Unidentified visual phenomena associated with space flight were rather common operationally," reveal the authors, "but... little or no documentation of past events has been made." Before UFO believers jump up and down with confirmation of a whole new family of "astronaut sightings of UFOs", the authors announce their intention of demonstrating that "such events were spacecraft debris associated with an earlier pyrotechnical operation, or ice, or window reflections. Cases for each of these theories have been presented and exhibits of similar occurrences are included. Positive identification was not possible... The quality of the imagery precludes a precise definition of the object under question... In general, it takes much more information to identify an object that it does to detect it."

Sixteen millimeter color magazine 1165M, exposed on Apollo-12, shows three objects, called "A", "B", and "C". The objects appeared during the LM jettison maneuver in lunar orbit. "A" is believed to be a small segment of the docking channel; "B" was identified by engineers as a portion of the docking ring, possibly the fiberglass seal; "C" was probably part of the electrical harness. All were near the spacecraft and were tumbling. From this and other examinations, Beatty and Baron concluded that "most 'moon pigeons' have as their source a programmed pyrotechnic event and are the normal debris associated with such an incident. They are often spectacular... The main thing to be learned from this study is that the event (in question) was, in all probability, a normal result of routine spacecraft operations... These data will undoubtedly be of use to the engineering, scientific, and public relations communities." The closing reference clearly indicates that Beatty and Baron were aware of the "Apollo-12 UFOs" controversy and felt that their study would be useful in demolishing any UFO buffs' wild rumors.

Unfortunately, the "moon pigeons" report seems to have been filed away in the NASA archives. Baron, who still works at the Johnson Space Center, told me early in 1976 that he never got any feedback on his report, even though it was fun doing it and it had

**EXCLUSIVE
NASA PHOTOS**



**These Are The Photos
Taken When Your TV
Screens Went Blank!**

This photo was snapped only moments after Aldrin's other Apollo 11 shot. Here the two UFOs have begun their separation and a halo-like force field between the two is clearly shown.

(26)

pretty obvious implications for UFO reports. NASA apparently decided to let the UFO writers spread their rumors, hoping that the stories would fade away if ignored.

What had happened, though, was a new shot in the arm for "astronaut UFO cases". The explanations could never catch up with the misinterpretations and wrong impressions engendered by the overheard conversations and viewed images from Apollo-12. Millions of Americans were practically eyewitnesses to a "space UFO", and were suitably impressed.

"Exclusive NASA Photos" and NASA censorship is another part of myth. These Apollo-11 spots are highly magnified window reflections in Lunar Module deep in space (Aldrin turned the camera on by accident while checking equipment).

When presented with the *Saga* story and with APRO's (and MUFON's) account of the "maneuvering alien spacecraft at 150,000 miles from Earth", the average citizen could only assume that it might indeed be true. If NASA was denying it, well then, the government has been known to lie to us in the past.

It is a vain hope to imagine that the truth will ever catch up to the Apollo-12 and other UFOs. As detailed here, the Apollo-12 UFO never existed. Somehow, millions of people believe that it did. There is sufficient blame

for this delusion to be generously distributed to UFO buffs, NASA public affairs officers, sensation-seeking news media, and lazy readers. And the "astronaut UFO" genre is not yet complete. Let's return to some more examples.

Another example of selective omission of facts occurs in the

Gemini-7 photo of sunlight glinting off roll thruster rockets on nose. Photo forgers airbrushed the nose/Earth boundary out, making the two lights appear to be floating in space. NASA photo S65-63722.

PHOTO ALSO REVERSED

(28)

(27)

Forgery can be reprinted in spite of copyright regulations because this is a NASA photo. Even retouched, it cannot be copyrighted.



(21)

NASA photo (right) SL3-118-2140 and variations (above and below) as published with erroneous captions.

"Fawcett list" of astronaut sightings. George Fawcett is a respected and level-headed UFO researcher in Maiden, North Carolina. But an example of his work gives a different impression:

"Gemini-XII: Jim Lovell and Edwin Aldrin saw four UFOs linked in a row. Both spacemen said the objects were not stars" (quoted from *The Edge of Reality*, Hynek & Vallee, 1975, page 64).

From the GT-12 Astronaut Debriefing, page K/3,4, Lovell relates: "During the last EVA we discarded, in addition to the ELSE (life support system), three bags. About 2, maybe 3 or possibly 4, orbits later at sunrise condition, we looked out again and saw 4 objects lined up in a row and they weren't stars I know. They must have been these same things we tossed overboard."

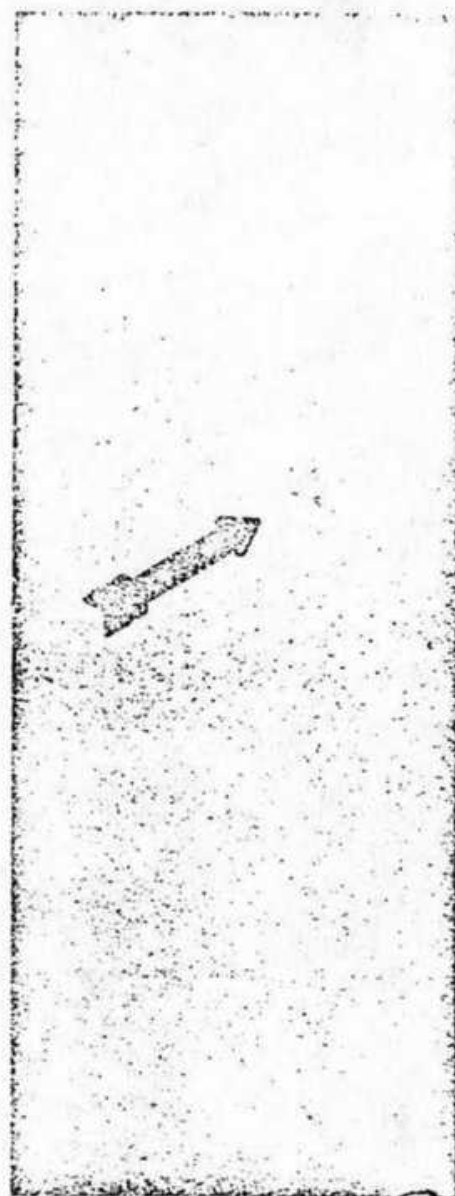
The original distortion of this entirely ordinary event, according to the Condon Report, is the responsibility of UFO writer, John Keel. Fawcett took it and embellished it.

Another of Fawcett's favorites is Mercury-7: "Scott Carpenter reported that he had what looked like a good shot of a saucer." Elsewhere he claimed that Carpenter "took a photograph of a classical saucer-shaped UFO with dome that followed his capsule." See plate 21

In fact, the photographs show an entirely ordinary object: a space balloon ejected from the capsule for

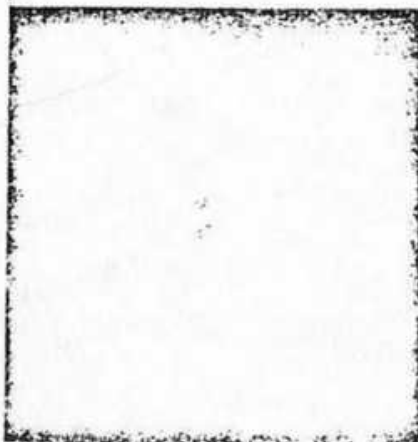
tracking practice. The balloon did not inflate but spun in a limp oblong sack. The flight schedule and the voice transmissions confirm this unexciting explanation—and confirm Fawcett's fantasizing.

An example of the difficulty of "disproving" an "astronaut UFO sighting" is the Mercury-9 case in 1963. Well established in the UFO lore, the story claims that on the 15th orbit, over Muchea, Australia, the astronaut (Gordon Cooper) saw a green object. More than one hundred people at the tracking station saw the bogie on a radar screen (this wasn't

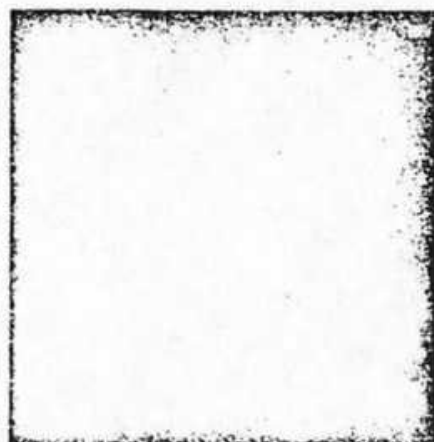


(30)

Shot during Sky Lab III second manned Sky Lab Flight 263 day of 1973—1645 Zulu Time.
NASA Photo = SL3-118-2140 (4 shots taken)
Listed as unidentified object or satellite by NASA
Photo Evaluation Lab



(31)



(32)

sensational enough for fictional "fact" writer Frank Edwards: he had *two* hundred people actually see the object).

The source of the story seems to have been an NBC newsmen in Australia. But the problem seems to be that Cooper has never heard of it. He has been out of the space program for seven years, and talks freely about UFOs to reporters, to the Columbia "UFO recording", to Mike Douglas, to friends and associates. Somehow he knows nothing about "his" space UFO—and he has no reason to be silent. *His* space UFO never existed.

Confronted by this evidence, Fawcett (letter of May 10, 1976) insists that "I sincerely believe *some* of the astronaut sightings are bonafide, based on some of my sources of information." John Keel, too, recalls (letter of March 26, 1976) that "ex-NASA engineers have told me all kinds of fascinating UFO tales..." Always these writers fall back on "secret reports" and "private information" when their published reports and open articles disintegrate in the face of the truth.

On October 18, 1973, the famous Mansfield, Ohio UFO sighting occurred, for which Captain Lawrence Coyne and his helicopter crew later were to receive the 'Best UFO Case of the Year' award (and check) from a weekly tabloid's 'blue-ribbon panel' of UFO experts. A few months later, Coyne said he was told by the panel chairman, J. Allen Hynek, (the respected head of the Center for UFO Studies) that Skylab astronauts had photographed the same UFO from space. (Hynek ultimately denied this.) A reputable magazine, "Army Reserve" published the story with an intriguing photograph it had received from NASA and which it labeled "NASA: Skylab", clearly indicating that this was the astronaut photograph which had buzzed Coyne.

It would have been a neat trick for the Skylab astronauts to have photographed anything on October 18th, since they weren't even on board the space station. The previous crew had returned to Earth a month before and their relief crew was not scheduled to blast off for another three weeks. The photograph printed in the magazine was clearly labeled on its backside as taken by Scott Carpenter on Mercury-7 more than ten years before. It showed a limp balloon Carpenter had

ejected from his spacecraft in an attempt to get visual tracking practice (this photo is often referred to as the "classical domed UFO" shot). UFO researchers and magazine editors had clearly not made even a minimum of effort to verify these transparent errors and mistakes, but instead passed on the false data to the public. Thousands more were deceived.

Late in 1973, a strange object did appear in Skylab space photographs. Taken on Conrad's Skylab flight in June, the object was not noticed by UFO researchers but by government photo analysts. *plate 33*

Rather than "sweep the UFO under the rug", the officials took the other tack: it might be a mysterious Soviet Satellite and could be of great value to



"UFO" seen from Skylab-2. The elongated object is actually an airstrip in the Brazilian jungles. Enlargement of NASA photo SL2-16-109.

←plate 21 again!

33

sensational enough for fictional "fact" writer Frank Edwards: he had *two* hundred people actually see the object).

The source of the story seems to have been an NBC newsmen in Australia. But the problem seems to be that Cooper has never heard of it. He has been out of the space program for seven years, and talks freely about UFOs to reporters, to the Columbia "UFO recording", to Mike Douglas, to friends and associates. Somehow he knows nothing about "his" space UFO—and he has no reason to be silent. His space UFO never existed.

Confronted by this evidence, Fawcett (letter of May 10, 1976) insists that "I sincerely believe some of the astronaut sightings are bonafide, based on some of my sources of information." John Keel, too, recalls (letter of March 26, 1976) that "ex-NASA engineers have told me all kinds of fascinating UFO tales..." Always these writers fall back on "secret reports" and "private information" when their published reports and open articles disintegrate in the face of the truth.

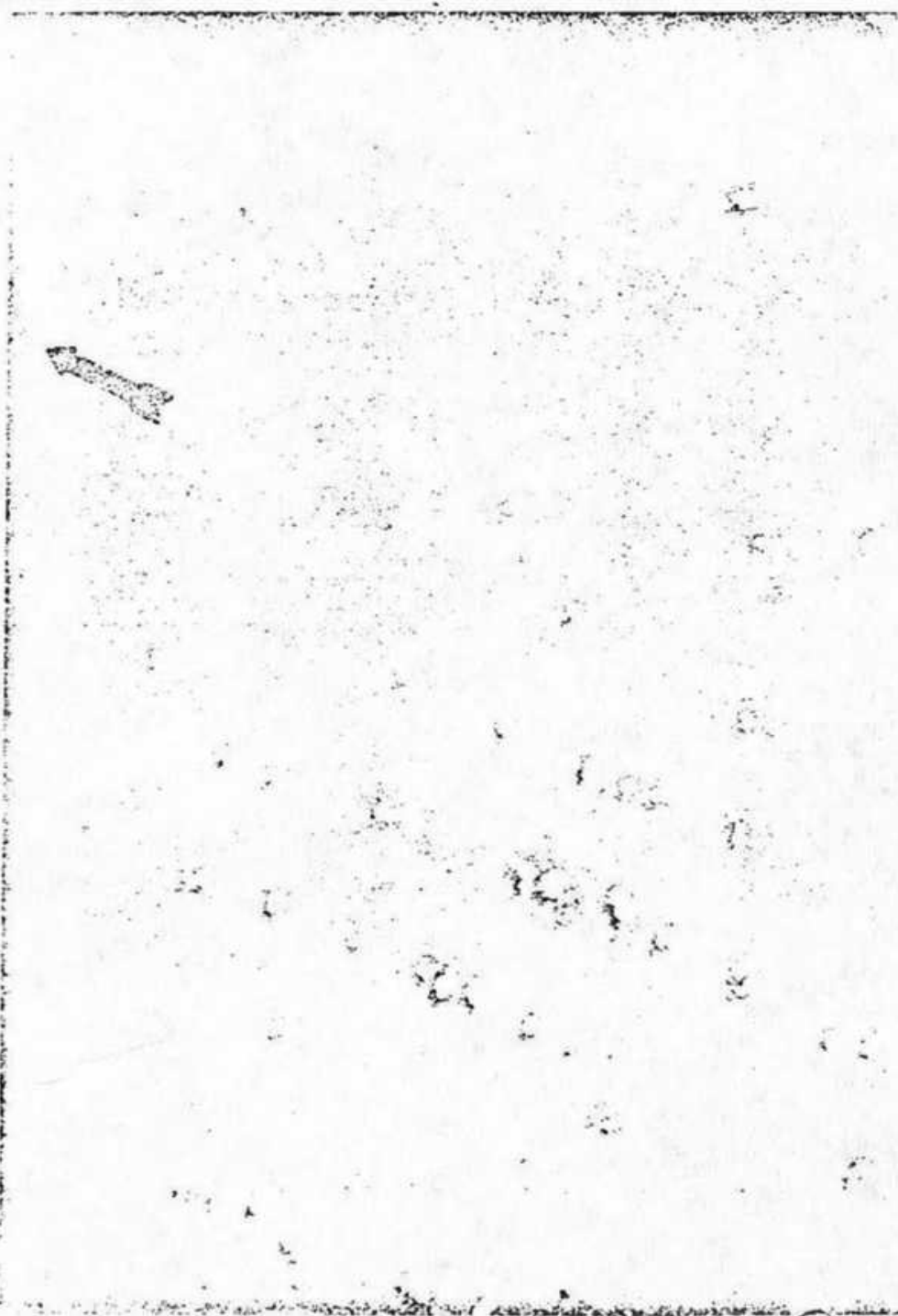
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"UFO" seen from Skylab-2. The elongated object is actually an airstrip in the Brazilian jungles. Enlargement of NASA photo SL2-16-109.

33

← plate 21 again!

military intelligence. A prompt and energetic investigation was launched.

The object looked like a long cylinder with two square paddles resembling solar panels at each end. By measuring its angular size on the negative, analysts were able to determine that it was about 20 feet long a mile away or 2000 feet long a hundred miles away.

A careful investigation revealed the surprising answer. the UFO was actually thousands of feet in length, but its altitude was zero! It was an *airstrip* in the Brazilian jungles! Further checking showed that the object appeared at the same spot in Skylab photos taken months later; the airfield was also found on an international aviation chart.

Recent UFO books and articles have resurrected the X-15 rocket plane sightings of fifteen years ago. This has prompted the NASA Headquarters Public Affairs Office to reissue a photograph taken by a belly camera of the spacecraft at an altitude of about 60 miles (photo 76-H-139). *plate 34*

Published reports speak of "fleets of UFOs" at a range of 30 feet from the X-15. But even a casual reader with any familiarity with spacecraft systems will recognize the effect for what it was: "fireflies". This is a phenomenon seen by many Mercury, Vostok, and later spacemen, as flecks of paint chipped off the spacecraft. On the X-15, it was flecks of ice clinging to the liquid oxygen tanks. The pilot clearly describes the pieces as being close-in, small, tumbling, and drifting along with his vehicle through the vacuum.

Considering these cases as I have described them (and there are other lesser ones which I have also investigated to a successful conclusion), what can we now say about authors who present such evidence of "astronaut UFOs"? While speaking ominously about a NASA coverup and of secret agencies which muzzle spacemen, these same researchers list such quotations as:

John Young: "Odds are UFOs exist".

Edgar Mitchell: "We all know UFOs are real".

Eugene Cernan: "I believe UFOs belong to someone else and that they are from some other civilization".

Gordon Cooper: "I believe that UFOs, under intelligent control, have

Flake of ice floating off of the X-15 rocket plane. Some investigators call this a "large UFO". NASA photo 76-H-139.

(34)



Clouds of debris surround the Saturn booster rocket following Apollo separation. Blow-up photos of individual pieces of debris inside and outside the cabin have been called "UFOs". NASA photo AS17-148-22687.

(35)

visited our planet for thousands of years".

None of these men claim to have seen UFOs in space. By now it should be obvious to open-minded investigators that no other astronaut claims to have seen any either. Suggestions that they have really done so are either misconceptions, misrepresentations, or frauds on the part of UFO writers.

Yet another case in point has just been given, and it deals with the John

Young quotation. Young, in Seattle in 1973, said that the chances were good that there were intelligent civilizations on other planets (AP, Nov. 27, 1973). The newsman started the article with the lead, "John Young says that the odds are that Unidentified Flying Objects do exist", even though none of Young's quoted words indicated that at all. Before you could say "UFO flap", the UFO writers had a new authority:

John Young says, "Odds are UFOs exist".

It seems clear that astronauts as a class of the population do not possess any special knowledge about UFOs which they may have gained from their own experiences. They are about as well informed (or more truthfully, as badly misinformed) as the average citizen. To quote them as above with the suggestion that they are special authorities on UFOs is a misleading

and intellectually dishonest tactic. Three time space veteran Wally Schirra, who according to UFOlogists saw "glowing masses" (actually lightning-lit clouds, over the Indian Ocean) has written, "I do not know enough about this subject to render an opinion of any kind. The only information I have is that which has been released to the public through the years by the various news media". UFO writers would have us believe that this is part of a vast conspiracy of lies which only they can penetrate.

The actual answer to the "shapeless light" mystery illustrates the way NASA faces real space mysteries. The crew was puzzled by the sighting but reported it to space officials who made no effort to conceal the incident. If NASA were trying to cover up actual UFO sightings by astronauts, this was a good candidate for one—and it would never have been publicized.

Astronaut Dick Gordon revealed to me the unpublicized solution to the publicized mystery. In a letter dated

September 15, 1976, Gordon wrote: "I vividly recall the incident which occurred when a light of indistinct shape and size was spotted on our return to earth. . . (it) did appear to be in the Indian Ocean. In our discussions and debriefings that occurred later, Rusty Schweikart provided the answer. He simply said, 'how about the moon's reflection?' and, of course, that is what it was. . . How often those of us in aviation have seen the moon's reflection on the water in the course of a normal flight. We simply did not put it together in returning from lunar distance, where we had the black background of space, the dark night of the earth, and the moon behind us."

Other spacemen have been asked to answer these questions). They have been forthright in their denials: "I never have personally seen anything I could identify as a UFO", says John Glenn, now a Senator from Ohio. Astronauts Grissom and Young said, "We have never seen any UFOs". Richard Gordon, who was with

Conrad on Gemini-11 and Apollo-12, writes that "I never saw a UFO". Astronaut "Deke" Slayton claims that "I don't recollect anyone reporting any UFOs on any of our flights".

"Buzz" Aldrin went to the moon on Apollo-11, on which the UFO press lists at least three separate UFO incidents. There were no UFOs: "There are people who say there's a government conspiracy to cover up the existence of flying saucers." Aldrin told a Reuters reporter in 1973, "That's a lot of hogwash."

The LM pilot on the next flight, Apollo-12, was Alan Bean. Following a new press conference in 1975 when James Harder repeated his stories of Apollo-11 and Apollo-12 UFOs, Bean told UPI that at no time during his mission did he ever see an unidentified object. "At no time did we see anything which was not of our spacecraft, either during lunar orbit or during the voyage to and from the moon," Bean stated.

A common source of space and other UFOs is shown here. The aura and the lens-shaped disc is actually a sunrise photographed from Skylab. NASA photo SL3-118-2177.



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The APRO Bulletin (Feb. 1976) continued to generate new astronaut UFO fairy tales with the anonymous revelation from "Mr. X", who heard the Apollo-11 astronauts describe "three disc shaped shadows that were pacing them across the surface of the moon." The best answer to this fabrication is in a letter from NASA Assistant Administrator for Legislative Affairs Robert F. Allnutt, to Congressman Bob Casey, dated January 29, 1970: "Conversation between the Apollo 11 crew and Mission Control were released live during the entire Apollo 11 mission. There were between 1000 and 1500 representatives of the news media present at the Houston News Center listening and observing, but not one has suggested that NASA withheld any news or conversations of this nature."

The evidence is clear. There is, out of all the dozens of "reports of astronaut UFO sightings", no residue of authentic cases, no 20% or 5% or even 0.01% of "true UFOs" behind all the "noise". My research is compelling in its conclusion: after fifteen years of manned space voyages including space stations and landing on the moon, spacemen have brought back not a shred of evidence—verbal, photographic, or otherwise—for the existence of extraterrestrial spacecraft, or "UFOs".

That evidence, if it exists at all, must be sought elsewhere. The performance and standards of conduct of the UFO groups and of UFO writers cannot be cause for optimism that such evidence, if it exists, will be recognized and correctly evaluated. The lesson of the "astronaut UFOs", then, teaches us nothing about UFOs, but a lot about UFO investigators.

Scientific Study of Unidentified Flying Objects (Condon Report), Bantam Edition, 1969, Chapter 6: Visual Observations Made by Astronauts/Franklin E. Roach. Pages 176-209, with bibliography through 1967. Good background material including unpublished valid solutions to a number of cases. Incorrect solution to Gemini-XI case. Inadequate analysis and unjustified endorsement of Gemini-IV case.

The Edge of Reality, by Hynek and Vallee. Henry Regnery & Co., 1975. Page 63-64 in a section called "The

Scientists at Work", we find the phony Fawcett list. List has incorrect dates and many flights out of sequence. On July 1, 1976, Dr. J. Allen Hynek reviewed my evidence and endorsed it, and repudiated the Fawcett list, which he reported that he included in his book as a curiosity only. That is, just because he presented it as fact to thousands of readers was no reason for anyone to conclude he thought it was true. This appallingly irresponsible attitude towards rules of evidence seems to infect the whole UFO field.

Sightings by 26 Astronauts Confirm: UFOs Spied on Skylabs (sic) Many Other Space Shots—UFOs Watch Every Move NASA Makes, Say Astronauts Who Were Tailed on Space Shot, "National Tattler", March 17, 1974. This is an embellished version of the same Fawcett fantasies. Weekly tabloid newspaper "conformed to the highest standards of modern reporting. Tattler and its staff are dedicated to total, truthful coverage..." In fact, staffer Robert Abborino made no effort to check any of Fawcett's outrageous claims.

UFOs Past, Present and Future, by Robert Emenegger, research by Alan Sandler. Ballantine, 1974. Chapter 15, "Nasa", pages 100-106. Extensive transcripts of space communications cover up the fact that Sandler carefully selected evidence and must have knowingly omitted information which would have explained many cases. An excellent photo section is included.

UFO Report, People Press, 1975. "NASA Hiding UFOs From You", by Robert D. Barry, pages 4-10. Barry is associated with Carl McIntyre's fundamentalist Christian group, and is one of the wilder UFO writers. Even the mass media has learned to disregard his fictional descriptions of non-events. Here, he explains "why NASA called in the CIA to keep these photos secret", without explaining how, in that case, he got copies. He uses the forged Gemini-7 photo proudly.

Flying Saucers—Here and Now!, by Frank Edwards, Lyle Stuart, New York, 1967. Astronaut fantasies wholly or in part created in the fertile (and unlimited by reality) mind of 'newsman' Frank Edwards are found on pages 13, 180, and 197. Through such entries a journalism student can trace the actual growth of the myth.

APRO Bulletin, March-April 1970

and February 1976 and others. This flying saucer club newsletter best typifies the disregard for impartial investigation of evidence which provided the climate in which the myth of "astronaut UFOs" could grow and flourish.

The Star, March 2, 1976, page 7. Sequence of headlines: On the front page, "Astronauts Say: We Saw UFOs in Space". On page 7, "Top Astronauts Confirm: We spotted two UFOs". In the article, McDivitt talks of his UFO, and Cooper discusses his experiences as a fighter pilot in Germany—and makes no mention of the space UFO associated with his name. The headlines, as can be expected in such a newspaper, are deliberately misleading.

SAGA magazine, May 1970: *Classified TOP SECRET—Apollo Astronauts Reported Two UFO Sightings*, by Beckley and Salkin, p. 13 ff. Complete story of Apollo-12 UFOs, plus enough false information to "discredit" the true explanation. Quotes "space expert Gary Henderson", another active spreader of the myth. Refers to long-discredited stories of "secret dead Russian cosmonauts" probably created by Frank Edwards.

Houston Post, Nov. 30, 1975, page 1D: "Just One Astronaut Claims Seeing UFO", by Jim Maloney. This sensible and sane investigation (McDivitt stuck to his story) clearly did not excite the national news media and was relegated to the obscurity of a local newspaper.

Science and Mechanics, June 1969. Cover Story: "This UFO was photographed by astronaut Gordon on Gemini 11 flight" (the cover photo shows a tremendously enlarged out of focus image of a piece of insulation floating a few inches in front of the camera). Page 44, Lloyd Mallan: "Are UFO Space Crews Spying on our Astronauts?" Description of the late L. Mallan's interviews on Gemini 12, provides some new information but cements some old misconceptions. Also embellishes Condon Report "unknowns".

Lockheed-NASA Contract NAS 9-5191 (March 1970), "Technical Report: Unidentified Visual Phenomena Associated with Space Flight", F. Beatty and J. Baron. Discusses the fragments seen and photographed on Apollo-12, and traces them to spacecraft effects.

REPLY TO:

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TTY: (202) 224-4479
e-mail: chuck_grassley@grassley.senate.gov
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United States Senate

CHARLES E. GRASSLEY

WASHINGTON, DC 20510-1501

August 3, 1998

REPLY TO:

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- ☐ 116 FEDERAL BUILDING
131 E. 4TH STREET
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Ms. Mary D. Kerwin
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Washington, DC 20546

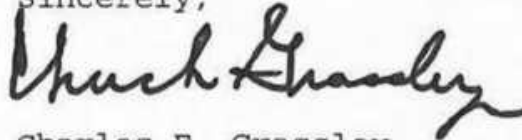
Dear Ms. Kerwin:

Enclosed please find a communication from (b) (6)
regarding several concerns about the space program.

I would appreciate any assistance you could provide pertaining to
this matter. Please mark your return correspondence to the
attention of Sherry Kuntz when responding to my office.

Thank you for your attention to my request.

Sincerely,



Charles E. Grassley
United States Senator

CEG/sk
Enclosure

FINANCE
JUDICIARY

Committee Assignments:

AGRICULTURE
BUDGET

CHAIRMAN,
SPECIAL COMMITTEE ON AGING

Author: (b) (6) <(b) (6)> at internet
Date: 7/6/98 04:14 PM
Priority: Normal
TO: chuck grassley at Grassley-DC
Subject: Message from a Voter

Greetings Honorable Senator Grassley,

I have recently encountered a number of new and interesting tidbits of information concerning letters I have previously written to you in regard of the UFO phenomenon that seems to be happening in the United States as well as the rest of the world. I greatly appreciate all the information you have led me to through our past correspondence. I am hoping you can help me track down a few more specific things. Here is a something I heard from someone I was corresponding with:

"On Sunday, August 10, 1997 at around 9:45am CDT, I was watching TV and switched to the NASA channel for news of the ongoing shuttle mission. At the time, they were broadcasting a nighttime view of Earth. As I watched, I was surprised to see a light rising vertically from the bottom of the screen where Earth was displayed. As it continued to rise vertically (relative to the TV screen), the shuttle camera clearly began to track the light and kept the picture centered on it.

"After it rose well above the horizon of Earth, the light made an apparent 90-degree turn to the right (again relative to the screen) and continued off in that direction. The shuttle camera continued to track the object and began to zoom in for a closer look. At that point NASA cut off the feed from the external camera and displayed the Houston space center instead. Unfortunately, I wasn't prepared to record this on my VCR. The entire episode lasted less than a minute, so I was unable to get the VCR ready in time."

I am also interested in any information that can be relayed about the Groom Lake Area, also know as Area 51, or Dreamland, and an area known as Area S-4. The media has stated that these areas in the Nevada desert are testing grounds for US "Black Projects". I believe that vehicles such as the SR-71 Blackbird, and the F-117 Stealth Fighter where tested here.

The government to date denies the existence of such places, even though I have in my possession of several videotapes, pictures, and even a Russian satellite image showing the area. Does such a place exist? Or at least, are you, the Air Force, or NASA, whoever happens to be in control of the site willing to tell us that it does exist. It is my understanding that the Nellis Air Force Base surrounds Area 51, so I imagine that the Air force is the one who has jurisdiction over the Area.

Many people including Bob Lazar, Bill Uhouse, and the father of a guy I work with all claim to have worked in this secret area, and have seen and worked on craft of an alien origin.

Bill Uhouse claims that both President Nixon, and Bush visited the Area 51 facility to examine the progress of recreating alien technology. He also claims that the project was going on with the aid of an alien "gray" known as Jarod (JAY-rod).

If there is any truth to their claims and the claims of many others, I would wonder why such a spectacular secret would be kept from us, and why the aliens would not have made themselves known to the general populace of Earth.

Please do not just send me another list of Project Blue Book documents, and I have already seen the censored files released by the CIA. These documents have been censored so all that they do is bring more suspicion toward the government, and they just make me think even more that someone is hiding something. The thing I can't figure out is why.

Anything you can do to help in my search for the hidden truth is greatly appreciated. Please help me find out if we do have aliens at Area 51, or even an admission that Area 51 exists.

Thanks Much.

(b) (6)



Here is a list of Organizations, and places which may be helpful in helping track down some information:

Organizations - Military groups and civilian contractors.

- * Nellis Air Force Base - Controls the land surrounding Area 51.

- * Nevada Test Site - Borders base on the west. Initially "owned" Area 51.

- * Security Anonymous "Cammo Dudes" patrolling base perimeter.

- * "Janet" Aircraft - Official EG&G "airline" ferrying workers to Groom Lake

- * Air Force Flight Test Center - Agency that controls Area 51. Based at Edwards Air Force Base.

- * EG&G Special Projects - General contractor at Area 51.

- * Bechtel - General contractor at Nevada Test Site, with some projects at Area 51.

- * Tonopah Test Range - "Semi-secret" aircraft testing base northwest of Area 51

- * Lockheed-Martin - Aircraft manufacturer for whom the base was built.

- * Johnson Controls - Contractor at Nevada Test Site, possibly also at Area 51.

- * Wackenhut Security - Security contractor at Nevada Test Site

Places

- * Rachel, Nevada - Nevada's "UFO Capital", the closest town to Area 51

- * Basecamp Airfield - "Secret" airfield in plain sight

- * Green River Launch Complex, Utah- According to "Popular Mechanics" the site of the "new Area 51"

- * Papoose Lake - Site of Lazar's "Area S-4" south of Groom Lake

- * Tikaboo Peak - Last accessible viewpoint into Area 51

Author: (b) (6) <(b) (6)> at internet
Date: 7/6/98 04:48 PM
Priority: Normal
TO: chuck grassley at Grassley-DC
Subject: NASA

This is a continuation of an e-mail I just sent you. These are some alleged conversations and observations made from NASA Astronauts. If there is ANY truth to this, there is a big shame shame, on NASA. If you could contact NASA on my behalf about these incidences I would be very grateful.

(b) (6)

Major Gordon Cooper

One of the original Mercury Astronauts and the last American to fly in space alone. On May 15, 1963 he shot into space in a Mercury capsule for a 22 orbit journey around the world. During the final orbit, Major Gordon Cooper told the tracking station at Much (near Perth Australia) that he could see a glowing, greenish object ahead of him quickly approaching his capsule. The UFO was real and solid, because it was picked up by Muchea's tracking radar.

Cooper's sighting was reported by the National Broadcast Company, which was covering the flight step by step; but when Cooper landed, reporters were told that they would not be allowed to question him about the UFO sighting.

Major Cooper was a firm believer in UFOs. Ten years earlier, in 1951 he had sighted a UFO while piloting an F-86 Sabrejet over Western Germany. They were metallic, saucer-shaped discs at considerable altitude and could out-maneuver all American fighter planes.

Major Cooper also testified before the United Nations:

"I believe that these extra-terrestrial vehicles and their crews are visiting this planet from other planets... Most astronauts were reluctant to discuss UFOs."

"I did have occasion in 1951 to have two days of observation of many flights of them, of different sizes, flying in fighter formation, generally from east to west over Europe."

And according to a taped interview by J. L. Ferrando, Major Cooper said:

"For many years I have lived with a secret, in a secrecy imposed on all specialists in astronautics. I can now reveal that every day, in the USA, our radar instruments capture objects of form and composition unknown to us. And there are thousands of witness reports and a quantity of documents to prove this, but nobody wants to make them public. Why? Because authority is afraid that people may think of God knows what kind of horrible invaders. So the password still is: We have to avoid panic by all means."

"I was furthermore a witness to an extraordinary phenomenon, here on this planet Earth. It happened a few months ago in Florida. There I saw with my own eyes a defined area of ground being consumed by flames, with four indentions left by a flying object which had descended in the middle of a field. Beings had left the craft (there were other traces to prove this). They seemed to have studied topography, they had collected soil samples and, eventually, they returned to where they had come from, disappearing at enormous speed... I happen to know that authority did just about everything to keep this incident from the press and TV, in fear of a panicky reaction from the public."

Ed White & James McDivitt

In June 1965, astronauts Ed White (first American to walk in space) and James McDivitt were passing over Hawaii in a Gemini spacecraft when they saw a weird-looking metallic object. The UFO had long arms sticking out of it. McDivitt took pictures with a cine-camera. Those pictures have never been released.

James Lovell and Frank Borman

In December 1965, Gemini astronauts James Lovell and Frank Borman also saw a UFO during their second orbit of their record-breaking 14 day flight. Borman reported that he saw an unidentified spacecraft some distance from their capsule. Gemini Control, at Cape Kennedy told him that he was seeing the final stage of their own Titan booster rocket. Borman confirmed that he could see the booster rocket all right, but that he could also see something completely different.

During James Lovell's flight on Gemini 7:

Borman: ER GEMINI 7, HOUSTON HOW DO YOU READ?

Control: Loud and clear 7 go ahead.

Borman: GOT A BOGEY AT 10 O'CLOCK HIGH.

Control: This is Houston. Say again 7.

Borman: SAID WE HAVE A BOGEY AT 10 O'CLOCK HIGH.

Control: Roger

Control: Gemini 7, is that the booster or is that an actual sighting?

Borman: WE HAVE SEVERAL...ACTUAL SIGHTINGS.

Control: ...Estimated distance or size?

Borman: WE ALSO HAVE THE BOOSTER IN SIGHT...

Further controller cuts in: Gemini control here again, the reference in that conversation was er bogey. It was er Borman who reported sighting the bogey. Er this is Gemini control Houston at er 4 hours 24 minutes into the flight.

Ironically, it was Lovell who made the classic statement "Please be informed that there is a Santa Claus". This was during his Apollo 8 flight on Christmas day in 1968 - some people believe there's a deeper meaning to these words, although the sceptics believe that this was little more than American humour. However, Walter Schitta, who was aboard Mercury 8, reputedly used Santa Clause as a code-name for a UFO presence, adding some weight to the argument that Lovell was experiencing another sighting.

Neil Armstrong & Edwin "Buzz" Aldrin

According to the NASA Astronaut Neil Armstrong the Aliens have a base on the Moon and told us in no uncertain terms to get off and stay off the Moon.

According to hitherto un-confirmed reports, both Neil Armstrong and Edwin "Buzz" Aldrin saw UFOs shortly after that historic landing on the Moon in Apollo 11 on 21 July 1969. I remember hearing one of the astronauts refer to a "light" in or on a crater during the television transmission, followed by a request from mission control for further information. Nothing more was heard.

According to a former NASA employee Otto Binder, unnamed radio hams with their own VHF receiving facilities that bypassed NASA's broadcasting outlets picked up the following exchange:

NASA: What's there?

Mission Control calling Apollo 11...

Apollo 11: These "Babies" are huge, Sir! Enormous!

OH MY GOD! You wouldn't believe it!

I'm telling you there are other spacecraft out there,

Lined up on the far side of the crater edge!

They're on the Moon watching us!

The two astronauts, talking to the NASA base in Houston.

Text of the conversation:

Astronaut 1: Ha! What is it?

Astronaut 2: We have some explanation for that?

--BEEP--

Houston: We have (not), don't worry, continue your program!

--BEEP--

Astronaut 1: Oh boy it's a, it's, it, it is really something (similar to)

fantastic here, you, you could never imagine this!

--BEEP--

Houston: Roger, we know about that, could you go the other way, go back the other way!

--BEEP--

Astronaut 1: Well it's kind of (rigged) ha, pretty spectacular
god ... what is that there? "

--BEEP--

Astronaut 1: It's (hollow), what the hell is that?

Houston: Go Tango, Tango!

--BEEP--

Astronaut 1: Ha! There's kind of light there now!

--BEEP--

Houston: Roger, we got it, we (watched it), lose communication,
Bravo Tango, Bravo Tango, select Jezebel, Jezebel!

--BEEP--

Astronaut 1: ya, ha! but this is unbelievable!

Houston: (we call you up Bravo Tango, Bravo Tango)!

A certain professor, who wished to remain anonymous, was engaged in a discussion with Neil Armstrong during a NASA symposium.

Professor: What REALLY happened out there with Apollo 11?

Armstrong: It was incredible, of course we had always known
there was a possibility, the fact is, we were
warned off! (by the Aliens). There was never any

question then of a space station or a moon city.

Professor: How do you mean "warned off"?

Armstrong: I can't go into details, except to say that their ships were far superior to ours both in size and technology - Boy, were they big!...and menacing! No, there is no question of a space station.

Professor: But NASA had other missions after Apollo 11?

Armstrong: Naturally - NASA was committed at that time, and couldn't risk panic on Earth. But it really was a quick scoop and back again.

According to a Dr. Vladimir Azhazha:

"Neil Armstrong relayed the message to Mission Control that two large, mysterious objects were watching them after having landed near the moon module. But this message was never heard by the public -- because NASA censored it."

According to a Dr. Aleksandr Kasantsev, Buzz Aldrin took color movie film of the UFOs from inside the module, and continued filming them after he and Armstrong went outside.

Armstrong confirmed that the story was true but refused to go into further detail, beyond admitting that the CIA was behind the cover-up.

Donald Slayton

Donald Slayton a Mercury astronaut revealed in an interview he had seen UFOs in 1951:

"I was testing a P-51 fighter in Minneapolis when I spotted this object. I was at about 10,000 feet on a nice, bright, sunny afternoon. I thought the object was a kite, then I realized that no kite is gonna fly that high."

As I got closer it looked like a weather balloon, gray and about three feet in diameter. But as soon as I got behind the darn thing it didn't look like a balloon anymore. It looked like a saucer, a disk.

About the same time, I realized that it was suddenly going away from me -- and there I was, running at about 300 miles per hour. I tracked it for a little way, and then all of a sudden the damn thing just took off. It pulled about a 45 degree climbing turn and accelerated and just flat disappeared."

Major Robert White

On July 17, 1962 Major Robert White reported a UFO during his fifty-eight-mile high flight of an X-15. Major White reported:

"I have no idea what it could be. It was grayish in color and about thirty to forty feet away." Then according to a Time Magazine article, Major White exclaimed over the radio:

"There ARE things out there! There absolutely is!"

NASA Pilot Joseph A. Walker

On May 11, 1962 NASA pilot Joseph Walker said that one of his tasks was to detect UFOs during his X-15 flights. He had filmed five or six UFOs during his record breaking fifty-mile-high flight in April, 1962. It was the second time he had filmed UFOs in flight. During a lecture at the Second National Conference on the Peaceful Uses of Space Research in Seattle, Washington he said:

"I don't feel like speculating about them. All I know is what appeared on the film which was developed after the flight." - Joseph Walker
To date none of those films has been released to the public for viewing.

Commander Eugene Cernan

Eugene Cernan was commander of Apollo 17. In a Los Angeles Times article in 1973 he said, about UFOs:

"...I've been asked (about UFOs) and I've said publicly I thought they (UFOs) were somebody else, some other civilization."

NASA's Maurice Chatelain

In 1979 Maurice Chatelain, former chief of NASA Communications Systems confirmed that Armstrong had indeed reported seeing two UFOs on the rim of a crater. Chatelain believes that some UFOs may come from our own solar system -- specifically Titan.

"The encounter was common knowledge in NASA, but nobody has talked about it until now."

"...all Apollo and Gemini flights were followed, both at a distance and sometimes also quite closely, by space vehicles of extraterrestrial origin - flying saucers, or UFOs, if you want to call them by that name. Every time it occurred, the astronauts informed Mission Control, who then ordered absolute silence."

Pilot Walter Schirra

"I think that Walter Schirra aboard Mercury 8 was the first of the astronauts to use the code name 'Santa Claus' to indicate the presence of flying saucers next to space capsules. However, his announcements were barely noticed by the general public."

James Lovell

It was a little different when James Lovell on board the Apollo 8 command module came out from behind the moon and said for everybody to hear: 'PLEASE BE INFORMED THAT THERE IS A SANTA CLAUS.' Even though this happened on Christmas Day 1968, many people sensed a hidden meaning in those words."

The rumors persist. NASA may well be a civilian agency, but many of its programs are funded by the defense budget and most of the astronauts are subject to military security regulations. Apart from the fact that the National Security Agency screens all films and probably radio communications as well. We have the statements by Otto Binder, Dr. Garry Henderson and Maurice Chatelain that the astronauts were under strict orders not to discuss their sightings. And Gordon Cooper has testified to a United Nations committee that one of the astronauts actually witnessed a UFO on the ground. If there is no secrecy, why has this sighting not been made public?

Shuttle Discovery - Mission 20

The voices of the astronaut and of the amateur radio station WA3NAN
Goddard in the Space Center of Greenbelt Maryland.

WA3NAN: We are retransmitting the Space Shuttle airground communication
from mission 20. This is WA3NAN.

Astronaut James F. Buchli...

Astronaut: Houston, this is Discovery, we still have the alien
spacecraft

under observance...

yellow

JUN 24 1998

L:ATW:mtg:L/1998-407f

The Honorable Olympia J. Snowe
United States Senate
Washington, DC 20510

Dear Senator Snowe:

Thank you for your May 18, 1998, letter on behalf of (b) (6) regarding Unidentified Flying Objects and his concern over the "authenticity of the recently released Mariner photographs."

There are no recently released Mariner photographs. We assume (b) (6) is referring to the images taken from our Mars Global Surveyor (MGS). NASA does not tamper with images received from MGS. These images are received on Earth in digital format, meaning "0 and 1". NASA merely translates these digital images, using computer processing, into actual images. All images and other instrument data is deposited in a publicly accessible archive within six months after receipt where they are available to everyone. All the images currently released can be found on the Internet at <http://photojournal.jpl.nasa.gov>.

We appreciate your interest in these matters, and trust this information will be helpful to you in responding to (b) (6)

Sincerely,

Respectfully,
Edward W. Heffernan

Edward Heffernan
(Acting) Associate Administrator
for Legislative Affairs

ecc:
S/Ruth Netting
LB/Barbara Cherry

Sent to Mark Berumen @ Hill Office (250 SROB)

6/22/98 aw

JP
6/22/98

United States Senate
WASHINGTON, DC 20510-1903

COMMITTEES:
ARMED SERVICES
BUDGET
COMMERCE, SCIENCE, AND
TRANSPORTATION
CHAIR OF
OCEANS AND FISHERIES
SUBCOMMITTEE
SMALL BUSINESS

May 18, 1998

Mr. Lawrence E. Medway
Director, Congressional Inquiries Division
National Aeronautic and Space Administration
300 E. Street, SW
Washington, D.C. 20546

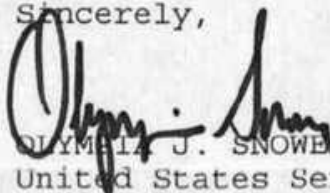
Dear Mr. Medway:

I am writing to you regarding the concerns of my constituent, (b) (6)
(b) (6), of Stonington, Maine.

(b) (6) is interested in U.F.O.'s and the recent photos of
Mars which were recently released. (b) (6) is not
convinced with the authenticity of the recently released Mariner
photographs. Further, he questions the authenticity based on the
picture only having 75 shades of grey, rather than the 256 it is
supposed to have. Any information you could provide which would
help me address his concerns would be appreciated.

Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,


OLYMPIA J. SNOWE
United States Senator

OJS:mjb

L98-407 - Sen. Snowe

Enclosed is a fact sheet entitled "The US Government and Unidentified Flying Objects." As stated in the second paragraph of the Fact Sheet, Congress, in 1993, directed NASA to end its search program. ~~Today the search for extraterrestrials is conducted through The Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence Institute (SETI Institute) in Mountain View, CA.~~

As for your interest in the recent photos of Mars taken from our Mars Global Surveyor (MGS), not the Mariner, these images are received on Earth in digital format, meaning "0 and 1". NASA does not tamper with these images. However, the images do require computer processing before they are suitable for public viewing. All images and other instrument data obtained from the MGS will be deposited in a publicly accessible archive, and they will then be available to everyone, scientists and citizens alike, who wants to examine them and draw their own individual conclusions. You can access all the images currently released from the following website: <http://photojournal.jpl.nasa.gov/>

We appreciate your interest in this matter and trust this information will be useful to you.

L98-407 - Sen. Snowe

Enclosed is a fact sheet entitled "The US Government and Unidentified Flying Objects." As stated in the second paragraph of the Fact Sheet, Congress, in 1993, directed NASA to end its search program. ~~Today the search for extraterrestrials is conducted through The Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence Institute (SETI Institute) in Mountain View, CA.~~

As for your interest in the recent photos of Mars taken from our Mars Global Surveyor (MGS), not the Mariner, these images are received on Earth in digital format, meaning "0 and 1". NASA does not tamper with these images. However, the images do require computer processing before they are suitable for public viewing. All images and other instrument data obtained from the MGS will be deposited in a publicly accessible archive, and they will then be available to everyone, scientists and citizens alike, who wants to examine them and draw their own individual conclusions. You can access all the images currently released from the following website: <http://photojournal.jpl.nasa.gov/>

We appreciate your interest in this matter and trust this information will be useful to you.

ACTION REQUIRED

CONGRESSIONAL INQUIRY

Office of Legislative Affairs
NASA Headquarters
300 E Street, SW
Washington, DC 20546

DATE: May 26, 1998
PAGES, if faxed: 3

TO:	S/Ruth Netting		Anne Ward
PHONE:		PHONE:	(202) 358-1946
FAX:		FAX:	(202) 358-4343

Action assigned to:	S/Ruth Netting
Due date:	June 9, 1998
Information copies:	
Action number / Member:	L98-407- Sen. Snowe

INSTRUCTIONS:

Please prepare a draft reply to the attached Congressional inquiry and send it via electronic mail to the following address: **Anne.Ward@hq.nasa.gov** or send a copy of your reply on a diskette to the attention of Anne Ward. If you need clarification of this assignment or additional time to prepare this reply, please contact Anne Ward.

MESSAGE:

Ruth, If you answer this before June 1, please send answer to me.

Thanks.

Helen

< CONFIRMATION REPORT >

05-26-1998(TUE) 10:26

[TRANSMIT]

NO.	DATE	TIME	DESTINATION	PG.	DURATION	MODE	RESULT
18502	5-26	10:25	NASA HQTS	2	0' 00' 52"	NORMAL	OK
				2	0' 00' 52"		

Headquarters Action Tracking System (HATS)
INCOMING CORRESPONDENCE ACTION
ID Number: L/1998-00407

Title: Sen Snowe fwds ltr from (b) (6), who's interested in U.F.O.
and the recent Mars photo

Recipient: L/Heffernan

Author: SNOWE
Organization: SENATE

Date Written: 05/18/1998

Date Received: 05/26/1998

Date Concurred:

Date Submitted:

Date Signed:

Date Closed:

Action Office: LD/Rothman:P

>>Current Due Date: 06/18/1998<<

Original Due Date:

Status: Open

Signature Office: L/Heffernan

Info Offices: L/Heffernan, L/Heninger, L/Kerwin

Abstract:

SEN SNOWE FWDS LTR FROM (b) (6) OF STOCKINGTON, MAINE, WHO'S
INTERESTED IN U.F.O.'S AND THE RECENT PHOTOS OF MARS WHICH WERE RECENTLY RELEASED.

Comments:

Action S/ Roth
Nothing
Due DATE: 6/19/98

Enclosures: NO

Related Records:

MARK BERGMAN
① 250 SROB

Keywords: (b) (6) STOCKINGTON, MAINE U.F.O. MARS
File Plan:

Analyst: BMoore

05/26/1998

Page 1 of 1

OK
2/2
6/19/98
DRAFT

L:ATW:mtg:L/1998-407f

✓
The Honorable Olympia J. Snowe
United States Senator
Washington, DC 20510

Dear Senator Snowe:

Unidentified Flying Objects
→ Thank you for your May 18, 1998, letter on behalf of (b) (6) regarding UFO's and his concern over the "authenticity of the recently released Mariner photographs."

The attached fact sheet, "The US Government and Unidentified Flying Objects," gives a brief history of NASA's investigations into UFO's. However, neither NASA or any other branch of the government is currently investigating UFO's.

Start
There are no recently released Mariner photographs. We assume (b) (6) is referring to the images taken from our Mars Global Surveyor (MGS). NASA does not tamper with images received from MGS. These images are received on Earth in digital format, meaning "0 and 1". NASA merely translates these digital images, using computer processing, into actual images. All images and other instrument data is deposited in a publicly accessible archive within six months after receipt where they are available to everyone. All the images currently released can be found on the Internet at <http://photojournal.jpl.nasa.gov>.

We appreciate your interest in these matters, and trust this information will be helpful to you in responding to (b) (6)

Sincerely,

Edward Heffernan
(Acting) Associate Administrator
for Legislative Affairs

~~Enclosure~~

ecc:
S/Ruth Netting
LB/Barbara Cherry

Sent to Mark Berumen @ Hill Office (250 SROB)

Headquarters Action Tracking System (HATS)
INCOMING CORRESPONDENCE ACTION
ID Number: L/1998-00494

Title: Ward/White House Referral: UFO Hearings

Recipient: A/Goldin

Author: (b) (6)

Organization: White House

Date Written: 05/17/1998

Date Received: 06/18/1998

Date Concurred:

Date Submitted:

Date Signed: 06/26/1998

Date Closed: 06/26/1998

Action Office: L/Ward:S

>>**Current Due Date:** 07/15/1998<<

Original Due Date: 07/15/1998

Status: Closed

Signature Office: L/Heffernan

Info Offices: L/Heffernan, L/Heninger, L/Kerwin

Abstract:

White House Correspondence from (b) (6) who supports having congressional hearing regarding the existence of UFO's.

Comments:

Note: Vanessa needs letterhead copy of signed/dated response.

Enclosures: White House Memo

Related Records: A/1998-00416

Keywords: (b) (6), UFO, hearings

File Plan: 1320.4

Analyst: JMassey

06/24/1998

Page 1 of 1

Yellow

JUN 24 1998

L:ATW:mtg:L/1998-494f

(b) (6)

Dear (b) (6):

The White House has requested NASA to respond to your May 17, 1998, letter to President Clinton concerning possible hearings on Unidentified Flying Objects (UFOs).

We are not aware of any hearings scheduled on UFO. Enclosed is a Fact Sheet, "The US Government and Unidentified Flying Objects," which gives a brief history of NASA's investigations into UFO.

We appreciate your interest in this matter and trust this information will be helpful to you.

Sincerely,

Edward Heffernan
(Acting) Associate Administrator
for Legislative Affairs

Enclosure

ecc:
S/Ruth Netting
LB/Barbara Cherry

Sent to Sue J. Smith
Director, Office of Agency Liaison
Room 6, OEOP
The White House
Washington, DC 20502

6/22/98 aw

JR

6/22/98

THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

6-4-98
DATE

MEMORANDUM FOR:

NASH, 24

FROM:

SUE J. SMITH *SM*
DIRECTOR, OFFICE OF AGENCY LIAISON

SUBJECT:

REFERRAL OF CASEWORK IN BULK

An unprecedented number of individuals still write the President and the First Lady for help. I know that this has meant a far greater volume of mail for your agency than ever before. I appreciate your continuing cooperation in our efforts to be as responsive as possible.

The attached letters have not received a White House Staff response. I am forwarding this correspondence to your agency for any appropriate action.

Please return the original incoming letter, along with a copy of any written or telephone response, to me at the address below. I also would appreciate your sending a copy of your agency's log of the names and addresses of these individuals. Any misreferrals should be returned to my office. If you have questions you can reach me at 456-7486.

Sue J. Smith
Director, Office of Agency Liaison
Room 6, OEOB
The White House
Washington, D.C. 20502

Again, thank you for your continuing help.

A/1998-00461

A98-01199

29

From nobody@www1.whitehouse.gov Sun May 17 17:57:37 1998
Date: Sun, 17 May 1998 17:54:05 -0400
From: (b) (6) >
Subject: Inbound-White House WWW MAIL => PRESIDENT
Apparently-to: president@WhiteHouse.GOV
To: president@WhiteHouse.GOV
Errors-to: The Postmaster <postmaster@www1.whitehouse.gov>
Reply-to: (b) (6) <(b) (6)>
Message-id: <199805172154.RAA07723@www1.whitehouse.gov>

Keywords: WWW-Correspondence; ; Ask a specific question regarding
Administration policy; Science or Technology; Private Citizen;
Comments: Forwarded from White House WWW
Comments: This message scanned by SCAN version 0.1 jms/960226

[Connection Information]

CLIENT: www-tr02.proxy.aol.com[152.163.201.136]
BROWSER: Mozilla/4.0 (compatible; MSIE 4.0; AOL 3.0; Windows 95; Sony
URL: http://www.whitehouse.gov/WH/Mail/html/Mail_President.html

[Sender Information]

PERSONAL-NAME: (b) (6)
EMAIL-ADDRESS: (b) (6)
ORGANIZATION:
RELATIONSHIP:
STREET-ADDRESS: (b) (6)
CITY: Ventura
STATE-PROVINCE: Ca
ZIP-CODE: 93004
COUNTRY: usa

[Message Information]

PURPOSE: Ask a specific question regarding Administration policy
TOPIC: Science or Technology
AFFILIATION: Private Citizen
SUBJECT: UFO's

[Message]

Dear Mr. President,
It is my understanding that you, Mrs. Clinton, Vice-President
Gore and heads of Congress, including the CIA director,
members of the Senate and House, the Executive Branch and
senior military reps in the Pentagon were briefed in or around
December of 1997 by Dr. Steven Greer, International Director
of CSETI(The Center for the Study of Extraterrestrial
Intelligence). Basically, he calls on you and other members of

congress to hold open congressional meetings. What is your position and intent on this matter? Will you push for open hearings or are you stonewalled as well by MJ-12? Certainly on your appointment as President you were briefed on the existence of UFO's. Please use your Executive power to report and open the truth to the American people. It is time. Your personal reply is respectfully requested. Thank you.

Sincerely,

(b) (6)

OK
DRAFT 6/19/98

L:ATW:mtg:L/1998-494f

(b) (6)

Dear (b) (6)

The White House has requested NASA to respond to your May 17, 1998, letter *to President Clinton* concerning possible hearings on *Unidentified Flying Objects (UFOs)* ~~UFO's~~.

We are not aware of any hearings scheduled on *which* ~~UFO's~~. The attached fact sheet, "The US Government and Unidentified Flying Objects," gives a brief history of NASA's investigations into *UFO's*. ~~However, neither NASA or any other branch of the government is currently investigating UFO's.~~

We appreciate your interest in this matter and trust this information will be helpful to you.

Sincerely,

Edward Heffernan
(Acting) Associate Administrator
for Legislative Affairs

Enclosure

Enclosed is a Fact Sheet, "Title..."

ecc:

S/Ruth Netting

LB/Barbara Cherry

Sent to Sue J. Smith

Director, Office of Agency Liaison

Room 6, OEOB

The White House

Washington, DC 20502

Headquarters Action Tracking System (HATS)
INCOMING CORRESPONDENCE ACTION
ID Number: L/1998-00494

Title: Ward/White House Referral: UFO Hearings

Recipient: A/Goldin

Author: (b) (6)

Organization: White House

Date Written: 05/17/1998

Date Received: 06/18/1998

Date Concurred:

Date Submitted:

Date Signed:

Date Closed:

Action Office: L/Ward:S

>>Current Due Date: 07/15/1998<<

Original Due Date: 07/15/1998

Status: Open

Signature Office: L/Heffernan

Info Offices: L/Heffernan, L/Heninger, L/Kerwin

Abstract:

White House Correspondence from (b) (6) who supports having congressional hearing regarding the existence of UFO's.

Comments:

Note: Vanessa needs letterhead copy of signed/dated response.

Enclosures: White House Memo

Related Records: A/1998-00416

Keywords: (b) (6) UFO, hearings

File Plan:

Analyst: JMasse

06/18/1998

Page 1 of 1

6/17/98
15:54:01

Page 1

CORRESPONDENCE ACTION STATUS HISTORY

Correspondence and Action Tracking System

Code A

ID Number: A98-01199

Title: WHR BULK: CONGRESSIONAL HEARINGS ON UFO'S

Recipient:
GOLDIN

Organization:
A

Date Written: 05/17/1998

Date Received: 06/17/1998

Original Date Due: 07/15/1998

***Other Recipients / Organizations*:**

>> Current Date Due: 07/15/1998 <<

Submitted for Signature:

Date Signed:

Date Completed:

Author:
(b) (6)

Organization:
WHR BULK

***Other Authors / Organizations*:**

Action Office: L

Action Officer: HEFFERNAN

Status: Open
Info Copies:

A, P

Security: Public

Signature Office: L

Signature Officer: HEFFERNAN

Priority: Normal

In/Out: Incoming

Abstract: WHR BULK: VIA E-MAIL, (b) (6) VENTURA, CA, SUPPORTS HAVING CONGRESSIONAL HEARINGS REGARDING THE EXISTENCE OF UFO'S.

Enclosures: NONE

Comment:

Keywords: WHR BULK CALIFORNIA CONGRESSIONAL HEARINGS UFO'S ET'S

Related Records:

Fileplan: 1320-1 G

Ad Hoc: A/1998-00461

Clerk: VC

Headquarters Action Tracking System (HATS)
INCOMING CORRESPONDENCE ACTION
ID Number: A/1998-00461

Title: WHR Bulk: Congressional Hearings on UFO's

Recipient: A/Goldin

Author: (b) (6)

Organization: WHR Bulk

Date Written: 05/17/1998

Date Received: 06/17/1998

Date Concurred:

Date Submitted:

Date Signed:

Date Closed:

Action Office: L/Heffernan

>>Current Due Date: 07/15/1998<<

Original Due Date: 07/15/1998

Status: Open

Signature Office: L/Heffernan

Info Offices: A/Goldin, P/WILHIDE

Abstract:

WHR Bulk: Via E-mail, (b) (6) Ventura, CA, supports having congressional hearings regarding the existence of UFO's.

Comments:

Enclosures: None

Related Records: A98-01199

Keywords: WHR Bulk California Congressional Hearings UFO's
File Plan: 1320-1 G

Analyst: VCoates

06/17/1998

Page 1 of 1

Headquarters Action Tracking System (HATS)
INCOMING CORRESPONDENCE ACTION
ID Number: L/1998-00470

Title: WARD/Rep. Gordon re taxpayers money on space aliens.

Recipient: L/Heffernan

Author: GORDON
Organization: HOUSE

Date Written: 06/04/1998
Date Received: 06/15/1998
Date Concurred:
Date Submitted:
Date Signed: 06/18/1998
Date Closed: 06/18/1998
>>Current Due Date: 07/06/1998<<
Original Due Date:

Action Office: L/Ward:S

Status: Closed

Signature Office: L/Heffernan

Info Offices: L/Heffernan, L/Heninger, L/Kerwin, LD/Rothman

Abstract:

REP. GORDON WRITES ON BEHALF OF (b) (6) RE TAXPAYERS MONEY BEING
SPENT ON SPACE ALIENS.

Comments:

Enclosures: YES LTR

Related Records:

Keywords: (b) (6) SPACE ALIENS TAXPAYERS MONEY, UFO
File Plan: 1320.4

Analyst: BMoore

06/18/1998

Page 1 of 1

yellow

JUN 18 1998

L:ATW:mtg:L/1998-470f

(b) (6)

Dear (b) (6)

Congressman Bart Gordon has asked NASA to respond to your recent letter to him wherein you enclosed an article on Congress funding the search for extraterrestrials.

Enclosed is a fact sheet entitled "The US Government and Unidentified Flying Objects." As stated in the second paragraph of the Fact Sheet, Congress, in 1993, directed NASA to end its search program.

Today the search for extraterrestrials is conducted through The Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence Institute (SETI Institute) in Mountain View, CA.

We appreciate your interest in this matter and trust this information will be useful to you.

Sincerely,

Original signed by
Lynn W. Heninger

Edward Heffernan
(Acting) Associate Administrator
for Legislative Affairs

Enclosure

cc:
The Honorable Bart Gordon

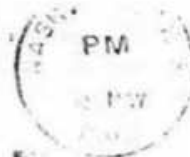
ecc:
S/Ruth Netting
LB/Barbara Cherry

Sent to Patton Lane @ Hill Office (2201 RHOB)

cd/15/98

HR
6/16/98

(b) (6)



Representative Bart Gordon
House of Representatives
Washington, D.C. 20515-4206



BART GORDON
6TH DISTRICT, TENNESSEE
COMMERCE COMMITTEE
SCIENCE COMMITTEE
RANKING MEMBER
SUBCOMMITTEE ON SPACE



Congress of the United States
House of Representatives

2201 RAYBURN BUILDING
WASHINGTON, DC 20515-4206
(202) 225-4231
FAX: (202) 225-6887

106 SOUTH MAPLE STREET
P.O. BOX 1986
MURFREESBORO, TN 37133
(615) 896-1986
FAX: (615) 896-8218

17 SOUTH JEFFERSON STREET
P.O. BOX 1140
COOKEVILLE, TN 38501
(931) 928-3907

June 4, 1998

Ms. Mary D. Kerwin
Deputy Associate Administrator For Legislative Affairs
National Aeronautics and Space Administration
Two Independence Square, Room 9L33
300 E St., SW
Washington, D.C. 20546

Dear Ms. Kerwin,

I am writing to you on behalf of my constituent, (b) (6), and have enclosed a copy of her inquiry. I would appreciate it if you would respond directly to my constituent, as well as send a copy to me for record keeping. I look forward to receiving your response.

Thank you in advance for your time and consideration in this matter. Please call if you need more information or have further questions.

Stay in touch,

BART GORDON
Member of Congress

BJG/pl

Congress blows \$120 million

I'm madder than R2D2 with a loose bolt that our free-spending Congress is paying 120 million bucks of hard-earned tax money on a project to contact space aliens!

Let's face it — why the hell are we spending big bucks looking for space aliens when they land here all the time?

All the eggheads at NASA have to
do is look out the window on a clear
night and they'd see
more UFOs than you
could shake a stick
at.

But no, they'd rather waste tons of taxpayers' cash.

Dr. Ruth Jones Hamer is the scientific queenpin behind this stupid Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence project that is expected to cost a whopping \$120 million over the next 10 years.

But what makes me so pig-biting mad is that we're aiming all these high-tech electronic listening devices at stars where only the most dimwitted aliens live.

That's right, folks
stupid aliens.

If they were smart, they would
have already have contacted us.
wouldn't they?

Or at least

buzzed Earth
In one of those
UFOs people
are seeing all
the time.

The bottom

line is that smart aliens are already here and the only ones we'll contact by radio waves are so dumb they'll never answer us anyway.

In fact, even if we did make contact with these half-cockroach, half-fish civilizations, what the hell are we going to learn from 'em — how to live under rocks?

Why the hell don't
WE get smart and try
to learn everything we

trying to talk to extraterrestrials

... & TAXPAYERS ARE FOOTING THE BILL

**Scientist wants
to talk to E.T.**
Search to start
for smart aliens

MOUNTAIN VIEW, Calif. — Dr. Ruth Jones Hamer takes extraterrestrials seriously. She has to. Congress has entrusted her with \$120 million this year to locate them. For the next 10 years Hamer of Search for Extraterrestrial



can about space creatures
who are already here, for
Pete's sake?

Those are the light-bulb heads we have to worry about. I've said it before and I'll say it again, the only good space alien is a dead space alien.

If these suckers are so damn smart, don't you ever wonder why the hell they haven't gone public?

Because most of them are evil and want to colonize the

Earth and make humans into slaves, that's why.

So I've got a better way to spend 120 million bucks — let's spend it on alien traps.

We could bait 'em with whatever these bug-eyed reptiles eat and end this alien threat to Earth once and for all

Ed Anger

NASA Facts FILE COPY

National Aeronautics and
Space Administration

NASA Headquarters
Public Affairs Office
Code P
300 E Street SW
Washington DC 20546



FS-1997-01-017-HQ

The US Government and Unidentified Flying Objects

No branch of the United States Government is currently involved with or responsible for investigations into the possibility of alien life on other planets or for investigating Unidentified Flying Objects (UFO's). The US Air Force (USAF) and the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) have had intermittent, independent investigations of the possibility of alien life on other planets; however, none of these has produced factual evidence that life exists on other planets, nor that UFO's are related to aliens. From 1947 to 1969, the Air Force investigated UFO's; then in 1977, NASA was asked to examine the possibility of resuming UFO investigations. After studying all of the facts available, it was determined that nothing would be gained by further investigation, since there was an absence of tangible evidence.

In October 1992, NASA was directed by Congress to begin a detailed search for artificial radio signals from other civilizations under the NASA Towards Other Planetary Systems (TOPS)/High Resolution Microwave Survey (HRMS) program (also known as the Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence project). Congress directed NASA to end this project in October 1993, citing pressures on the US Federal budget. The HRMS did not detect any confirmed signal before it was stopped. However, similar work will continue in a more limited manner through efforts of private groups and through academic institutions. The Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence Institute (SETI Institute) in Mountain View, CA, effectively replaced the Government project, borrowing the signal processing system from NASA. The SETI Institute is a nonprofit corporation conducting research in a number of fields including all science and technology aspects of astronomy and planetary sciences, chemical evolution, the origin of life, biological evolution, and cultural evolution.

During several space missions, NASA astronauts have reported phenomena not immediately explainable; however, in every instance NASA determined that the observations could not be termed "abnormal" in the space environment. The 1947 to 1969 USAF investigations studied UFO's under Project Blue Book. The project, headquartered at Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, Ohio, was

terminated December 17, 1969. Of the total of 12,618 sightings reported to Project Blue Book, 701 remain "unidentified."

The decision to discontinue UFO investigations was based on an evaluation of a report prepared by the University of Colorado entitled, "Scientific Study of Unidentified Flying Objects;" a review of the University of Colorado's report by the National Academy of Sciences; previous UFO studies; and Air Force experience investigating UFO reports during the 1940's, '50's and '60's. As a result of experience, investigations, and studies since 1948, the conclusions of Project Blue Book were: (1) no UFO reported, investigated, and evaluated by the Air Force was ever a threat to our national security; (2) there was no evidence submitted to, or discovered by, the Air Force that sightings categorized as "unidentified" represented technological developments or principles beyond the range of modern scientific knowledge; and (3) there was no evidence indicating that sightings categorized as "unidentified" were extraterrestrial vehicles.

With the termination of Project Blue Book, the USAF regulation establishing and controlling the program for investigating and analyzing UFO's was rescinded. Documentation regarding the former Project Blue Book investigation was permanently transferred to the Modern Military Branch, National Archives and Records Service, in Washington, DC 20408, and is available for public review and analysis.

Since the termination of Project Blue Book, nothing has occurred that would support a resumption of UFO investigations by the USAF or NASA. Given the current environment of steadily decreasing defense and space budgets, it is unlikely that the Air Force or NASA will become involved in this type of costly project in the foreseeable future.

Since neither NASA nor the Air Force is engaged in day-to-day UFO research, neither one reviews UFO-related articles intended for publication, evaluates UFO-type spacecraft drawings, or accepts accounts of UFO sightings or applications for employment in the field of aerial phenomena investigation.

UFO Points of Contact

1. For further information on the Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence, please contact the SETI Institute, 2035 Landings Drive, Mountain View, CA 94043, (415) 960-4530.
2. News media requiring Project Blue Book files should contact the National Archives Public Affairs Office, (202) 501-5525. Public queries should be addressed to the Project Blue Book archivist at (202) 501-5385. For queries not related to Project Blue Book, contact the National Archives receptionist at (202) 501-5400. Documentation is available from: Modern Military Branch, National Archives and Records Service, Eighth Street and Pennsylvania Avenue, NW, Washington, DC 20408.
3. The Air Force publication, "The Roswell Report: Fact vs.

Fiction in the New Mexico Desert," a lengthy document providing all of the details available from the Air Force on the Roswell incident, is available for \$52 from the US Government Printing Office, Superintendent of Documents, Mail Stop: SSOP, Washington, DC 20402-9328.

4. There are a number of universities and professional scientific organizations that have considered UFO phenomena during periodic meetings and seminars. A list of private organizations interested in aerial phenomena may be found in *Gale's Encyclopedia of Associations*.
 5. Persons wishing to report UFO sightings are advised to contact law enforcement agencies.
-

Responsible NASA Official: Elsie Weigel - eweigel@hq.nasa.gov
Web Page Curator: Woody Smith - woody.smith@hq.nasa.gov
Web Designer: Pamela Sams

Revised: February 14, 1997

012
212
6116/98

DRAFT

L:ATW:mtg:L/1998-470f

(b) (6)

Dear (b) (6):

Congressman Bart Gordon has asked NASA to respond to your recent letter to him wherein you enclosed an article on Congress funding the search for extraterrestrials.

Enclosed is a fact sheet entitled "The US Government and Unidentified Flying Objects." ~~You will note that in the second paragraph, the Congress in 1993 directed NASA to end its search for extraterrestrials.~~

Today the search for extraterrestrials is conducted through The Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence Institute (SETI Institute) in Mountain View, CA.

We appreciate your interest in this matter.

Sincerely,

Edward Heffernan
(Acting) Associate Administrator
for Legislative Affairs

Enclosure

cc:
The Honorable Bart Gordon

As
stated
in the
second
paragraph
of the
fact
sheet,

and I trust this information
will be useful to you.

its search program.

ecc:

S/Ruth Netting

LB/Barbara Cherry

Sent to Patton Lane @ Hill Office (2201 RHOB)

1320.4 Aeronautics: U.F.O

LA98-00106

Security: U

Type: I

Written: 03/16/98

To: Name
GOLDIN

No. Organization
1 ADMINISTRATOR
0
0

Received: 04/23/98

From: (b) (6)

43 WHR
0
0

Action/Info: A

Due Date - Current: 05/28/98
Due Date - Original: 05/28/98
Suspense Status: C
Date Completed: 05/01/98

Action Office: L/S WARD
Info Copy: AI, EH, LH, MDK
Signature Office: HENINGER
Enclosures: N
Clerk: JM

Topics

Keywords

(b) (6)

WHITE
HOUSE
CSETI
HEARING
PUBLIC
UFO
EXTRATERRESTRIAL
EVIDENCE

Interim Replies

Dates:

Comments:

Response Progress:

Rel'd records: A98-00789

File plans: 1320.4

Storage Location:

Summary of Contents:

WHITE HOUSE REFERRAL: (b) (6), MEMBER OF CSETI, SUPPORTS OPEN CONGRESSIONAL HEARINGS, OR A PRESIDENTIAL DISCUSSION, REGARDING EVIDENCE AS TO THE EXISTENCE OF ALIEN BEINGS AND SPACECRAFT.

Referred
From:

No. Organization
0
0
0

Public Hearings on U.F.O.

yellow

MAY 1 1998

L:ATW:mtg:LA98-106f

(b) (6)

Dear (b) (6) :

The White House has forwarded to NASA for response your letter of March 16, 1998, in which you advocate Congressional Hearings or a Presidential Discussion regarding alien beings and their spacecraft.

Enclosed is a NASA Fact Sheet entitled "The U.S. Government and Unidentified Flying Objects." This Fact Sheet gives a brief outline of NASA's research into UFO's and will give you other points of contact you may wish to pursue.

We appreciate your interest in this matter.

Sincerely,
Original signed by
Lynn W. Meninger

Edward Heffernan
(Acting) Associate Administrator
for Legislative Affairs

Enclosure

This letter came to us via the White House Bulk Mail

5/1/98 acc

DR
5/1/98

AE

5/1/98

4/22/98
15:46:44

Correspondence and Action Tracking System

CORRESPONDENCE ACTION

Code A

ID Number: A98-00789

Title: WHR BULK: PUBLIC CONGRESSIONAL HEARINGS ON EXTRATERRESTRIAL EVIDENCE

Recipient: GOLDIN

Organization: A

***Other Recipients / Organizations*:**

Date Written: 03/16/1998

Date Received: 04/22/1998

Original Date Due: 05/28/1998

>> Current Date Due: 05/28/1998 <<

Submitted for Signature:

Date Signed:

Author: (b) (6)

Organization: WHR BULK

***Other Authors / Organizations*:**

Date Completed:

Action Office: L

Signature Office: L

Status: Open

Action Officer: HEFFERNAN

Signature Officer:

In/Out: Incoming

Info Copies:

A, AB, S, P

Priority: Normal

***Responsible Office / Responsible Officer (Due Date)*:**

Abstract: WHR BULK: (b) (6) MINNEAPOLIS, MN, & MEMBER OF CSETI, SUPPORTS OPEN CONGRESSIONAL HEARINGS, OR EVEN A PRESIDENTIAL DISCUSSION, REGARDING EVIDENCE AS TO THE EXISTENCE OF ALIEN BEINGS AND SPACECRAFT IN OUR GOVERNMENT'S POSSESSION.

Enclosures: NONE

Comments:

Ad Hoc:

Clerk: VC

Headquarters Action Tracking System (HATS)
INCOMING CORRESPONDENCE ACTION
ID Number: A/1998-00310

Title: WHR Bulk: Public Congressional Hearings on Extraterrestrial Evidence

Recipient: A/Goldin

Author:

(b) (6)

Organization: WHR Bulk

Date Written: 03/16/1998

Date Received: 04/22/1998

Date Concurred:

Date Submitted:

Date Signed:

Date Closed:

Action Office: L/Heffernan

>>Current Due Date: <<

Original Due Date:

Status: Open

Signature Office: L/Heffernan

Info Offices: A/Goldin, AB/Heffernan, P/WILHIDE, S/HUNTRESS

Abstract:

WHR Bulk: (b) (6) Minneapolis, MN, Member of CSETI, supports open Congressional Hearings, or even a Presidential discussion, regarding evidence as to the existence of alien beings and spacecraft in our Government's possession.

Comments:

Enclosures: None

Related Records: A98-00789

Keywords: WHR Bulk Open Congressional Hearings Alien Beings ET's spacecraft CSETI

File Plan:

Analyst: VCoates

04/22/1998

Page 1 of 1

MAST

From nobody@www1.whitehouse.gov Mon Mar 16 22:19:34 1998

Date: Mon, 16 Mar 1998 22:16:43 -0500

From: (b) (6) <(b) (6)>

Subject: Inbound-White_House_WWW_MAIL => PRESIDENT

Apparently-to: president@WhiteHouse.GOV

To: president@WhiteHouse.GOV

Errors-to: The Postmaster <postmaster@www1.whitehouse.gov>

Reply-to: (b) (6) <(b) (6)>

Message-id: <199803170316.WAA14132@www1.whitehouse.gov>

**IGNORE POLITICAL
COMMENTS**

*J. I. [unclear]
as that as
repeat?
SW*

Keywords: WWW-Correspondence; ; Ask a specific question regarding

Administration policy; Science or Technology; Private Citizen;

Comments: Forwarded from White House WWW

Comments: This message scanned by SCAN version 0.1 jms/960226

[Connection Information]

CLIENT: 206.147.215.243[206.147.215.243]
BROWSER: Mozilla/2.0 (compatible; MSIE 3.02; Windows 3.1)
URL: http://www.whitehouse.gov/WH/Mail/html/Mail_President.html

[Sender Information]

PERSONAL-NAME: (b) (6)
EMAIL-ADDRESS: (b) (6)
ORGANIZATION: CSETI
RELATIONSHIP: member
STREET-ADDRESS: (b) (6)
CITY: Minneapolis
STATE-PROVINCE: MN
ZIP-CODE: 55405
COUNTRY: USA

[Message Information]

PURPOSE: Ask a specific question regarding Administration policy
TOPIC: Science or Technology
AFFILIATION: Private Citizen
SUBJECT: public congressional hearings on extraterrestrial evidence

[Message]

Dear Mr. President:
During these trying days in your Presidency, I want to let
you know and appreciate the work you have done as President

A/1998-00310

A98-00789

and the warmth and good humor you've displayed. I would like to suggest as a way of changing the headlines about sex in the White House, to an area that would give you a real legacy and enlighten the world as to are place in the universe...

As a member of CSETI, I support open Congressional Hearings or even a Presidential Discussion - public - regarding evidence as to the existence of alien beings and spacecraft in our government's possession. Last April members of your staff were present during Congressional Hearings in private with people who were in someway connected with knowledge about alien beings, ET technology, spacecraft. Did those discussions make you more interested to know more or are you being advised not encourage any more meetings with CSETI?

Sometimes, sir... you have to take a positive risk on matters that can change the world for the better. The Richard Helms and Strom Thurmond types must be dealt with firmly. Whether it's opening Cuba to economic trade or a healthy discussion on a matter that will be far more remembered than whom you may or may not have had sex with, standing up to these dinosaurs and people like them, will go a long way in the American public's and historians recognition of you as a leader to another level.

I do not have CSETI's telephone number in order for you and your staff to coordinate hearings with Dr. Steven Greer. But, his website address is: www.cseti.org

I've heard early in your Presidency you asked former colleague Webster Hubbel to investigate what is

known about UFO's. I think compared to past presidents, you have been kept in the dark about ET

matters. Well, I hope that your interest in the topic hasn't totally diminished. Scientists, engineers, former astronauts, militay personnel and just plain citizens would like to speak up and discuss what they know. The American public's attitude would turn from initial cynicism to enlightenment. Even if it means we are not on good terms with are alien visitors, or we are not the smartest or strongest intelligent power out there, we can handle it.

So... I do hope you receive this e-mail and not just one of the many assistants answering letters for you. This letter can make a difference... and so can you Mr. President. It won't cost millions of dollars to conduct a hearing/investigation of potential huge benefits to so many.

Best Regards,

(b) (6)

OK
WR
5/1/98

L:ATW:mtg:LA98-106f

DRAFT

(b) (6)

Dear (b) (6)

The White House has forwarded to NASA for response your letter of March 16, 1998, in which you advocate Congressional Hearings or a Presidential Discussion regarding alien beings and their spacecraft.

Enclosed is a NASA Fact Sheet entitled "The U.S. Government and Unidentified Flying Objects." This Fact Sheet gives a brief outline of NASA's research into UFO's and will give you other points of contact on the subject you may wish to pursue.

We appreciate your interest in this matter.

Sincerely,

Edward Heffernan
(Acting) Associate Administrator
for Legislative Affairs

Enclosure

Headquarters Action Tracking System (HATS)
INCOMING CORRESPONDENCE ACTION
ID Number: L/1998-00415

Title: ROTHMAN/Sen Snowe fwds ltr from (b) (6), who's interested in U.F.O.'s sightings and abductions

Recipient: L/Heffernan

Author: SNOWE
Organization: SENATE

Date Written: 05/13/1998
Date Received: 05/27/1998
Date Concurred:
Date Submitted:
Date Signed: 05/27/1998
Date Closed: 05/27/1998
>>Current Due Date: 06/17/1998<<
Original Due Date:

Action Office: LD/Rothman:P

Status: Closed

Signature Office: L/Heffernan

Info Offices: L/Heffernan, L/Heninger, L/Kerwin

Abstract:

SEN SNOWE FWDS LTR FROM (b) (6) WHO'S INTERESTED IN UFO'S SIGHTINGS AND ABDUCTIONS.

Comments:

Helen spoke w/staffer referring him to Air Force; fwdded fax sheet on UFOs.

Enclosures: YES LTR

Related Records:

Keywords: (b) (6) U.F.O. SIGHTINGS ABDUCTION
File Plan: 1320.4

Analyst: BMoore

05/27/1998

Page 1 of 1



Date: 5/27/98
Time: 2:05

To: Mark Berumen

Phone#: _____
Fax#: 224-1946

From: **Helen Rothman**
Director, Congressional Inquiries Division
Office of Legislative Affairs
Voice#: (202) 358-1943
Fax#: (202) 358-4343

Message: Mark - EACT Sheet per our
conversation
Helen Rothman

Number of Pages _____ including cover

NASA Facts

National Aeronautics and
Space Administration

NASA Headquarters
Public Affairs Office
Code P
300 E Street SW
Washington DC 20546



FS-1997-01-017-HQ

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could not be termed "abnormal" in the space environment. The 1947 to 1969 USAF investigations studied UFO's under Project Blue Book. The project, headquartered at Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, Ohio, was terminated December 17, 1969. Of the total of 12,618 sightings reported to Project Blue Book, 701 remain "unidentified."

The decision to discontinue UFO investigations was based on an evaluation of a report prepared by the University of Colorado entitled, "Scientific Study of Unidentified Flying Objects;" a review of the University of Colorado's report by the National Academy of Sciences; previous UFO studies; and Air Force experience investigating UFO reports during the 1940's, '50's and '60's. As a result of experience, investigations, and studies since 1948, the conclusions of Project Blue Book were: (1) no UFO reported, investigated, and evaluated by the Air Force was ever a threat to our national security; (2) there was no evidence submitted to, or discovered by, the Air Force that sightings categorized as "unidentified" represented technological developments or principles beyond the range of modern scientific knowledge; and (3) there was no evidence indicating that sightings categorized as "unidentified" were extraterrestrial vehicles.

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UFO Points of Contact

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4. There are a number of universities and professional scientific organizations that have considered UFO phenomena during periodic meetings and seminars. A list of private organizations interested in aerial phenomena may be found in *Gale's Encyclopedia of Associations*.
5. Persons wishing to report UFO sightings are advised to contact law enforcement agencies.

< CONFIRMATION REPORT >

05-27-1998(WED) 13:57

[TRANSMIT]

NO.	DATE	TIME	DESTINATION	PG.	DURATION	MODE	RESULT
18529	5-27	13:55	202 224 1946	3	0°01'31"	NORM.E	OK
				3	0°01'31"		

< CONFIRMATION REPORT >

05-27-1998(WED) 13:57

[TRANSMIT]

NO.	DATE	TIME	DESTINATION	PG.	DURATION	MODE	RESULT
18529	5-27	13:55	202 224 1946	3	0°01'31"	NORM.E	OK
				3	0°01'31"		

OLYMPIA J. SNOWE
MAINE
COUNSEL TO THE ASSISTANT
MAJORITY LEADER
250 RUSSELL SENATE OFFICE BUILDING
(202) 224-5344

United States Senate

WASHINGTON, DC 20510-1903
May 13, 1998

COMMITTEES:
ARMED SERVICES
BUDGET
COMMERCE, SCIENCE, AND
TRANSPORTATION
CHAIR OF
OCEANS AND FISHERIES
SUBCOMMITTEE
SMALL BUSINESS

Mr. Lawrence E. Medway
Director, Congressional Inquiries Division
National Aeronautic and Space Administration
300 E. Street, SW
Washington, D.C. 20546

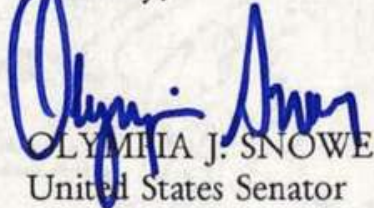
Dear Mr. Medway:

I am writing to you regarding the concerns of my constituent, (b) (6) of
Portland, Maine.

(b) (6) is interested in U.F.O. sightings and abductions. I have enclosed a copy
of his correspondence for your review. Any information you could provide which
would help me answer his questions would be appreciated.

Thank you for your time and attention.

Sincerely,


OLYMPIA J. SNOWE
United States Senator

OJS:mjb

AUBURN
TWO GREAT FALLS PLAZA
SUITE 7B
AUBURN, ME 04210
(207) 786-2451

AUGUSTA
68 SEWALL STREET, SUITE 101C
AUGUSTA, ME 04330
(207) 622-8292

BANGOR
ONE CUMBERLAND PLACE, SUITE 306
BANGOR, ME 04401
(207) 945-0432

BIDDEFORD
231 MAIN STREET, SUITE 2
BIDDEFORD, ME 04005
(207) 282-4144

PORTLAND
3 CANAL PLAZA, SUITE 601
P.O. Box 188
PORTLAND, ME 04112
(207) 874-0883
MAINE RELAY SERVICE
TDD 1-955-3323

PRESQUE ISLE
169 ACADEMY STREET, SUITE 3
PRESQUE ISLE, ME 04769
(207) 764-5124

2137983 m54

APR 0 / 1998

FEBUARY 22 1998

TIME- 9:11am

Dear Senitor Olyimpia Snow,

My name is (b) (6) I'm from Portland, Maine. I'm 12 years old. (b) (6) I heard about the fredom of information act. I would be so grateful it you could get any or all government documents released on the Roswell crash. I'm a U.F.O. researcher. I have heard about the following U.F.O. sightings and abductions:

1. LAS LUNAS, NEW MEXICO LATE JUNE 1977 11:30A.M.
2. SHIROYAMA, KAWANOE CITY JAPAN FEB/2/75 16:00 MILITARY TIME
3. WAIKIKI BEACH, HONOLULU, HAWAII MARCH/15/93 12:00 P.M.
4. COLFAX, WISCONSIN APRIL/19/78 13:30 MILITARY TIME
5. DENVER, COLARODO MAY/1991 AFTERNOON
6. BARCELONA, SPAIN JUNE/1978 SUNDOWN
7. MONTEMORELOS, NUEVA LEON, MEXICO SUMMER OF 1994 AFTERNOON
8. VANCOUVER, B.C. CANADA OCTOBER/17/1992
9. GULF BREEZ, FLORADA SEPTEMBER/24/1994 18:50 MILITARY TIME
10. ZACATELCO, TLAXCALA, MEXICO OCTOBER/31/1991
11. VIBORG, JUTLAND, DENMARK NOVEMBER/17/74 9:00 A.M.
12. COCOYOC, MORELOS, MEXICO NOVEMBER/3/73 9:00 A.M.
13. BELJUM MIDNIGHT
14. MT. KIDTARDIN, MAINE MIDNIGHT 3 CAMPERS WERE ABDUCTED
15. GROOM LAKE NEVADA AREA 51 FREQUNTLY

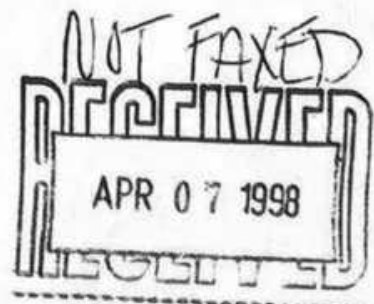
As you have read Ido know alot aboout U.F.O'S. I also knoew in RIGHT PATTERSON AIR FORCE BASE, OHIO THERE KEEPING ALIENS AND CRAFT IN HANGER 18. THERE IS ALSO A GOVERNMENT AGENCY CALLED M.J.12.

I know that U.F.O'S visit america frequently and our government knows about it. Soon every political persons are going to get a pition from a high school in New Hampshire to have information on the Roswell crash released to the public. I have heard roomers that at HULAMAN AIR FORCE BASE A U.F.O. LANDED AND THE HIGH RANKING PERSON AT THE BASE TALKED TO THE ALIEN. The government made a big mistake by letting Aliens into the country and can do nothing about it.

sincerely,
(b) (6)

P.S.

I'm including my address, phone number, and P.O. box.



Headquarters Action Tracking System (HATS)
INCOMING CORRESPONDENCE ACTION
ID Number: L/1998-00415

Title: ROTHMAN/Sen Snowe fwds ltr from (b) (6) who's interested in
U.F.O.'s sightings and abductions

Recipient: L/Heffernan

Author: SNOWE
Organization: SENATE

Date Written: 05/13/1998

Date Received: 05/27/1998

Date Concurred:

Date Submitted:

Date Signed:

Date Closed:

Action Office: LD/Rothman:P

>>Current Due Date: 06/17/1998<<

Original Due Date:

Status: Open

Signature Office: L/Heffernan

Info Offices: L/Heffernan, L/Heninger, L/Kerwin

Abstract:

SEN SNOWE FWDS LTR FROM (b) (6) WHO'S INTERESTED IN UFO'S SIGHTINGS AND
ABDUCTIONS.

Comments:

Enclosures: YES LTR

Related Records:

Mark
Berumen
Steffa
(H:11)

4/1946

Keywords: (b) (6) U.F.O. SIGHTINGS ABDUCTION
File Plan:

Analyst: BMoore

05/27/1998

Page 1 of 1